

General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

August 2, 2021 via Video Conference

1:00 p.m.

The trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. held their third quarterly meeting via video conference with Chair Linda Chezem, presiding.

Chair Linda Chezem opened with a moment of silence, followed by the serenity prayer, and then called the meeting to order, welcoming all and inviting them to introduce themselves.

Present: Molly Anderson; Beau Bush; Hon. Christine Carpenter; Cathi Clark; Jimmy Dean; Josh Eggleston; Kathryn Fowler; Francis H. Gilroy; Tom Hoban; Sister Judith Ann Karam, CSA; Patricia LaNauze; Deborah Koltai; Jan Lembke; Mike Lewis; Nancy J. McCarthy, Al J. Mooney, M.D.; Paz Preciado; Kevin Prior, MBA, CFA, CPA; Marita Rhinehart; and Irma Van De Bon-Nicol.

At the invitation of the Board, the following persons were also present: Amy Bailey, Terry Bedient, Brenda Brown, Clement Cann, Chris Cavanaugh, Patrick Claymore, Irene Donoso, James Hurst, Racy Joseph, Paul Konigstein, Diana Lewis, Stephanie Lyles, Zenaida Medina, Michelle Mirza, Steve Smith, Craig Weidner, Bob Wilcox, Sandra Wilson, Jeff Wine, and Jacob Diaz, recording secretary.

Minutes: Following a motion and second, the minutes of the May 22, 2021 Special General Service Board Meeting were approved.

Chair's Report: Chair Linda Chezem expressed her delight at having Bob Wilcox on board as the new general manager and Chris Cavanaugh coming aboard as the new Grapevine publisher. Linda shared her gratitude for her recent trip to G.S.O. She looks forward to moving out of this difficult time with COVID and believes we will find that the hand of A.A. is ever more needed.

Communications: Secretary Francis Gilroy reported that the board has received five communications. He described the first three letters, each expressing concerns about Advisory Actions of the 71st General Service Conference, and the responses they received. The last two letters will be responded to soon. All were distributed to the board members.

Corporate Reports:

Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.): Chairperson Jimmy Dean presented a written report on behalf of the corporation.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report.

Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.: Chairperson Josh Eggleston presented a written report on behalf of the corporation.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report.

Reports of Trustees' Committees:

Trustees' Archives Committee: Chairperson Al Mooney presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Archives Committee.

Trustees' General Service Conference Committee: Chairperson Kathi Fowler presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The Board approved a recommendation that two new Scope items, 9 and 10, be added to the trustees' General Service Conference Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure that read as follows:

9. The 71st G.S.C. advisory action that the Equitable Distribution of Workload process be implemented for the 72nd G.S.C. on a three-year trial basis. The committee will provide a progress report to the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions each year during the three-year trial period.
10. Annually appoint a subcommittee on the G.S.C. Committee Workload, on a three-year trial basis beginning July 2021. The subcommittee is tasked with performing analysis of the proposed agenda item scoring tools and creating an equitable distribution of workload plan for the full trustees' committee to review and approve at the winter Board Weekend.

The Board approved a recommendation that the request for two persons from A.A. in Brazil, Maria do Carmo Angelin Inojosa Zanré and Ana Elisa Limeira, Board of Trustees "Class B," be approved to attend the 2022 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as observers.

The Board also approved a recommendation that the request for one person from A.A. in Argentina, a trustee, be approved to attend the 2022 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as an observer.

A motion was made to recommit the recommendation to further review the proposal: To extend an open invitation to all Panel 70 delegates to attend a future face-to-face General Service Conference as a non-voting observer with each delegate to cover their own expense for the trip. The motion to recommit failed.

The Board considered the recommendation to further review the proposal: To extend an open invitation to all Panel 70 delegates to attend a future face-to-face General Service Conference as a non-voting observer with each delegate to cover their own expense for the trip. Concerns were raised about the fairness of the opportunity only being available to those who could afford to pay for the trip. The Board did not approve this recommendation.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.

Trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee: Chairperson Nancy McCarthy presented a written report on behalf of the committee. Nancy shared the news that ACM George Wright, who has been assisting the committee with military-related initiatives, regrettably had to step down. The committee expressed its deep appreciation to George for his years of service to the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Committee on C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities.

Trustees' Corrections Committee: Chairperson Mike Lewis presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Committee on Corrections.

Trustees' Literature Committee: Chairperson Deborah Koltai presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Literature Committee.

Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee: Chairperson Kevin Prior presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The Board approved a recommendation to accept the re-forecasted budget, which reflects gross sales of \$11,400,000, contributions revenue of \$10,000,000 and a bottom-line surplus of \$667,710.

The Board approved a recommendation to immediately transfer \$250,000 to the Reserve Fund.

The Board approved a recommendation to accept the Auditor Selection Policy with a clarification that the current auditors are also eligible to be part of the Request for Proposal (RFP) process.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee.

Trustees' International Committee: Chairperson Trish LaNauze presented a written report on behalf of the committee. Trish thanked Mary Cumings for her stellar service on the International assignment and is delighted that Racy Joseph is now joining the team. Trish observed that the opening up of virtual platforms has led to countless new opportunities for expanded communication, relationships, and unity. She noted that activity on the International assignment has quadrupled.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Procedure #5 of the trustees' International Composition, Scope and Procedure which currently reads:

5. The committee reviews suggestions regarding international travel made by the Trip Consultation Team, which includes as its members: the chair of the General Service Board, both trustees-at-large, U.S. and Canada, general manager of G.S.O. and the staff member on the International assignment.

Be revised to reflect the change made by the committee's February 2015 decision as follows:

5. The committee reviews suggestions regarding international travel made by the Trip Consultation Team, which includes as its members: the chair of the General Service Board, both trustees-at-large, U.S. and Canada, another trustee appointed by the General Service Board chair, general manager of G.S.O. and the staff member on the International assignment.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that General Service Board U.S./Canada contribute \$5,000 (US) to the REDELA Fund.

The Board approved a recommendation that advisory actions 32 and 33 of the 71st General Service Conference (listed below) be forwarded to the General Service Board and that a committee(s) be formed to discuss these actions and that both domestic (U.S./Canada) and international impact be considered in all discussions and implementation.

32. The U.S./Canada General Service Structure recognize online groups and encourage their participation, listing those groups who ask to be listed within the group's preferred district and area, with the default option being the location of the group's primary contact. This supersedes the 1997 Advisory Action that designated online groups as "International Correspondence Meetings."
33. The General Service Board form a committee to explore future possibilities for the participation of online groups in the U.S./Canada General Service structure.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' International Committee.

Trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee: Chairperson Francis Gilroy presented a written report on behalf of the committee. Francis expressed appreciation for the interpretation services which have been arranged and are enabling good communication between himself and the French-speaking delegate chair.

The Board approved a recommendation that the virtual pan-continental Special Forum targeting certain international, and U.S./Canada remote communities be held on December 11, 2021.

The Board approved a recommendation that Al-Anon/Alateen be invited to participate in A.A.'s 2025 International Convention in Vancouver, BC, Canada. Al-Anon's participation will be based on their participation in Toronto (2005), San Antonio (2010), Atlanta (2015) and Detroit (2020) – unfortunately cancelled due to the impact of Covid-19.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee.

Trustees' Nominating Committee: Chairperson Jan Lembke presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The Board approved a recommendation that Kirk Holmes of Las Vegas, NV and Morgan Biggs of New Orleans, LA be appointed to serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Public Information Committee commencing with the July 2021 General Service Board Weekend.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Nominating Committee.

Trustees' Public Information Committee: Chairperson Beau Bush presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The Board approved a recommendation that the staff secretary move forward and engage the professional survey methodologist to conduct a focused review and analysis of the A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire at a cost not to exceed \$8,000 (the current amount in the reforecast 2021 trustees' PI budget category for this item).

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

Audit Committee – Chairperson Kevin Prior gave a verbal report on behalf of the committee. The committee met on Sunday, April 12, 2021 and provided a report in May, 2021.

Retirement Committee – Chairperson Paul Konigstein gave a verbal report on behalf of the committee. The Retirement Committee met on February 23, 2021 and received their regular report from B.P.A.S. on the performance of the organization's portfolio, which was slightly greater than the targeted return. The committee also received a report from B.P.A.S. on pension annuitization and will be studying the issue further.

Report of General Sharing Session: Francis Gilroy presented a written report of the General Sharing Session on the topic, "The Minority Voice." A summary of the report and presentations are attached. Francis looks forward to further discussions about possibly returning to a Town Meeting format for the General Sharing Session.

Trustees' Planning and Sharing Session: The trustees met on Sunday, August 1, 2021 at 5:00 p.m. for the trustees' Planning and Sharing Session. Board chair Linda Chezem summarized the session which included a discussion of finances, a review of recent agenda items, and several items to be introduced in new business. There was not adequate time for a full discussion of a Process for Development of Criteria, Design, and Initiation of the next G.S.O. Location Study. This item will be on the agenda at the November Board meeting.

Reports of Trustees' Activities: Trustees submitted written reports of their activities since the February meeting. A synopsis of the reports is attached to these minutes.

New Business: Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Michelle Grinberg be appointed Trustee Emerita to the General Service Board.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that the ad hoc committee on the Strategic Plan continue and that the GSB Chair appoint members to serve on that committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board unanimously approved a recommendation that the General Service Board form a committee, with members to be appointed by the chair, to discuss advisory actions 32 and 33 of the 71st General Service Conference (listed below) and that both domestic (U.S./Canada) and international impact be considered in all discussions and implementation.

32. The U.S. Canada Service Structure recognize online groups and encourage their participation, listing those groups who ask to be listed within the group's preferred district and area, with the default option being the location of the group's primary contact. This supersedes the 1997 Advisory Action that designated online groups as "International Correspondence Meetings"
33. The General Service Board form a committee to explore possibilities for the participation of online groups in the U.S./Canada General Service structure.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that an ad hoc committee on Inclusivity and Living into Our Third and Fifth Traditions be appointed by the chair. The committee shall seek opportunities to expand inclusivity and accessibility in our general service structure, and A.A. as whole, by looking for means to lead by example within the structures of our boards, our corporations, and our committees. (It was clarified that this committee is continuing the work of the ad hoc committee on Outreach to Encourage Minority Participation in General Service which was appointed in 2020.)

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation to allow the Fourth Quarter 2021 General Service Board meeting to take place outside of New York County, if necessary.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation to establish an ad hoc committee to review recommendations regarding G.S.B. Policy on Streamlining Initiatives.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that the Board continue the Trustee Orientation ad hoc committee, and that the G.S.B. Chair appoint new committee members. The committee will continue developing orientation materials for Class A and Class B trustees.

Following a motion and second, the Board considered a recommendation to invite the Panel 70 Delegates, and their guests to the Opening Dinner of the 72nd General Service Conference. The G.S.B. will cover the cost of travel, hotel (for one night), and the dinner. Concerns were raised about the cost and the precedent that the action might set. Trustees expressed compassion and commiseration for the Panel 70 delegates not being able to experience an in-person General Service Conference but shared that they had heard from Panel 70 delegates who did not feel a trip to G.S.O. would remedy that. The recommendation was not approved.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved the appointments of the chairs and members of the following Committees of the Corporation:

Audit Committee

Kevin Prior, chair
Cathi Clark
Francis Gilroy
Marita Rhinehart
Linda Chezem, GSB chair/ex-officio
Jimmy Dean, A.A.W.S. Chair/consultant
Josh Eggleston, AA GV Chair/consultant
Paul Konigstein, A.A.W.S. CFO/consultant

Compensation Committee

Francis Gilroy, chair
Kathi Fowler
Mike Lewis
Paz Preciado
Linda Chezem, GSB chair/ex-officio
Bob Wilcox, A.A.W.S. President/consultant
Chris Cavanaugh, AA GV Publisher/consultant
Jimmy Dean, A.A.W.S. Chair/consultant

Josh Eggleston, AA GV Chair/consultant
Carolyn Walsh, A.A.W.S. Director/consultant
Paul Konigstein, A.A.W.S. CFO/consultant

The board began discussing what the process might be for deciding if the Fourth Quarterly Meeting would be held in-person, online-only, or in a hybrid format. It was agreed that more information and more discussion was needed.

There being no further business, the Third Quarterly Meeting of the Trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. adjourned at 5:50 p.m.

PENDING APPROVAL

Trustees' activities since the February meeting:

Molly Anderson

**Check-in with Irma V. on Wednesdays at 9pm EST*

Other one-on-one meetings with Nancy McCarthy, Beau B., Josh E., and Francis G.

May 1	General Service Board Meeting
May 26	Trustee Buddy Orientation
May 29	General Manager Interviews
June 4 – 6	Northeast Regional Forum
June 11 – 13	General Service Board Orientation
June 19	Area 50 Meeting
	Meeting with Trustee Buddy*
June 25	AAWS Board Meeting
June 26	Grapevine Board Meeting
July 30 – August 2	GSB Quarterly Meeting

Cathi Clark

May 1	General Service Board meeting
	AAGV Board Meeting (Observer)
May 2	A23 Virtual Assemblies ad hoc committee meeting
May 8	A23 Guidelines review
May 10	Trustee Buddy meeting
May 15	North/South Connection Special Forum
May 16	A23 Assembly
May 18	Trustee Buddy meeting
May 22	General Service Board Special Meeting GSO GM Search
May 23	ECR Delegates Virtual Breakfast
	A23 Guidelines review
	A23 Virtual Assemblies ad hoc committee meeting
June 3	Trustee Buddy meeting
June 4 - 6	Northeast Regional Forum
June 11 – 13	Trustee Orientation
June 17	Trustee Buddy meeting
June 20	ECR Delegates Virtual Breakfast
June 25	AAWS Board meeting (Observer)
June 26	AAGV Board meeting (Observer)
July 1	Trustee Buddy meeting
July 15	Trustee Buddy meeting
July 18	A22 Interpretation/Translation ad hoc committee meeting
July 29	AAGV Board meeting (Observer)
July 30 – August 2	General Service Board Weekend

Linda Chezem

May 1	Elected as Chair, General Service Board
May 15 – 16	North South Regional Forum
May 22	Special General Service Board meeting
June 5 – 6	Northeast Regional Forum
June 11 – 13	General Service Board Orientation

July 10	Al Anon Celebration
July 21	Three Chairs Visit to the General Service Office (In Person)
July 30 – August 2	GSB Quarterly Meeting

Jimmy Dean

February 4	GSB Censure Ad Hoc Meeting
February 5	GM Search Committee Meeting
	Interim GM Compensation Meeting
February 8	ICOAA Prep Meeting
February 9	Finance Advisory Body (FAB) Meeting
	ICOAA Meeting
February 11	GSB Strategic Planning Meeting
February 12	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting
	GM Search Committee Meeting
February 13	Concepts Workshop Dist. 22/A65
February 16	AAWS Special Meeting
	GSB Censure Ad Hoc Meeting
February 17	AAWS Special Meeting
February 20	Area 65 CPC Presentation
February 22	AAWS IAC Meeting
February 23	GSB Retirement Committee Meeting
February 24	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting
February 25	AAWS Nominating Meeting
February 26 – 27	WRAASA
March 2	GSB Strategic Planning Meeting (Zoom)
March 5	AAWS Planning/Sharing Meeting (Zoom)
March 8	Board Chairs Meeting (Zoom)
March 9	Finance Advisory Body (FAB) Meeting (Zoom)
	AAWS IAC Meeting (Zoom)
	SW Regional Delegates Bring to Date (Zoom)
March 10	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting (Zoom)
March 11	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
March 12 – 14	SW Regional Delegates (SWRDA) Assembly (Zoom)
March 17	AAWS IAC Exec Session (Zoom)
March 18	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
March 19	AAWS IAC Exec Session (Zoom)
March 23	AAWS IAC Exec Session (Zoom)
March 24	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting
	AAWS IAC Exec Session
March 26	GM Search Committee Meeting
March 30	Finance Committees Joint Meeting
April 5	Trustee's Delegate Orientation
April 6	GM Interviews
April 7	GSB Sub-Committee on Nominating Procedure #9 (GM)
April 9	GM Interviews
April 10	District 91 Waco/Area 65 Service Talk (In person)
April 12	Trustees Farewell
	AAWS Prep for GM Interviews
April 13	Finance Advisory Body (FAB) Meeting
	AAWS GM Interviews

	Board Chairs Meeting
April 14	AAWS IAC Meeting
April 15	AAWS GM Interviews
April 16	AAWS GM Interviews
April 17 – 24	General Service Conference
April 30	AAWS Chair Meet w/Interim GM
May 1	GSB Annual Meeting
	AAWS Annual Meeting
May 4	AAWS Chair Meet w/GSB Chair
May 5	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting
May 6	GSO All Employee Huddle
May 7	GSB/AAWS/AAGV Chairs Meeting
May 10	AAWS Chair Meet w/Interim GM
May 11	Finance Advisory Body (FAB) Meeting
	ICOAA Meeting
May 17	AAWS Chair Meet w/Interim GM
	Trustee Orientation Meet w/Irma
May 19	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting
May 20	Meeting about GSB Special Meeting
	AAWS Nominating Committee Meeting
	GM Search Committee Meeting
May 21	Meeting about AAWS Board Agenda
May 22	GSB Special Meeting (GM Interview/Hire)
May 24	AAWS Chair Meet w/Interim GM
May 25	AAWS Sharing Session
May 26	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting
May 28	ICOAA Managers Meeting
June 1	AAWS IAC Meeting
	Concept 6 Presentation (Area 06 N Ca)
June 2	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting
June 3	Meeting about AAWS Background Prep
	NE Regional Forum Touchpoint Meeting
June 4 – 6	NE Regional Forum (As AAWS Director)
June 7	AAWS Chair Meet w/ GM
	Canadian Employment Meeting
June 8	Trustee Orientation Walk Through
June 9	AAWS Board Meeting Prep
June 10	Meet w/CFO Paul (w/ John W.)
June 11 – 13	Trustee Orientation
June 12	Texas State Convention Service Talk – Ft. Worth, TX (In person)
June 14	AAWS Chair Meet w/GM
June 16	Finance Advisory Body (FAB) Meeting
June 21	AAWS Chair Meet w/GM
June 23	GSB/AAWS/AAGV Chairs Meeting
June 24	AAWS Director Orientation
June 25	AAWS Board Regular Meeting
June 28	AAWS Chair Meet w/GM
July 1	Board Chairs w/GM & Publisher Meeting
July 6	Meeting about NetSuite Webstore Problems
July 7	AAWS Chair Meet w/GM
July 8	AAWS Self-Support Committee Meeting

July 9	AAWS Nominating Committee Meeting ICOAA Manager Meeting AAWS IAC Committee Meeting
July 12	AAWS Chair Meet w/GM
July 13	ICOAA Steering Committee Meeting
July 15	GSB/AAWS/AAGV Chairs Meeting
July 16 – 18	Area 25 (Kansas) Election Assembly – Salina KS (In person)
July 19	AAWS Chair Meet w/GM
July 20 – 22	Board Chairs to GSO (In person)
July 23	District 40 Area 87 Service Talk
July 27	AAWS Nominating Committee Meeting
July 29	AAWS Board Regular Meeting
July 30 – August 2	GSB Quarterly Meeting

Josh Eggleston

March 16	TCPI CMP Committee Meeting
March 18	TCPI / CPI Joint Meeting
March 20	AAGV Planning Meeting
March 24	Trustee's Orientation Ad Hoc Committee
March 30	TCF / CCF Joint Meeting
March 31	AAGV Publisher Search Committee
April 1	AAGV / CCGVLV Joint Meeting
April 7	Trustee's Orientation Ad Hoc Committee AAGV Publisher Search Committee
April 8	ICYPAA Planning Meeting Albin Z Farewell
April 9	Weekly GV Chair Status call
April 12	Audit Committee Meeting
April 13	TCPI PSA Review
April 14	AAGV Publisher Search Committee
April 17 – 25	General Service Conference
April 28	AAGV Publisher Search Committee
May 1	2 nd Quarterly GSB Meeting
May 5	Trustee's Orientation Ad Hoc Committee AAGV Publisher Search Committee
May 9	General Service Board Meeting
May 11	Finance Advisory Body Meeting
May 21	Weekly GV Chair Status call
May 22	General Service Board Meeting
May 26	Trustee's Orientation Ad Hoc Committee AAGV Publisher Search Committee
May 28	Weekly GV Chair Status call
June 2	Trustee's Orientation Ad Hoc Committee AAGV Publisher Search Committee
June 4	Weekly GV Chair Status call
June 8	Trustee's Orientation Tech Rehearsal
June 11	Weekly GV Chair Status call
June 11 – 13	Trustee Orientation
June 16	Finance Advisory Body Meeting AAGV Publisher Search Committee

June 18	Weekly GV Chair Status call
June 23	Board Chairs/ GM Meeting
June 25 – 26	A.A.G.V. Board Planning Meetings and Director Orientation
July 7	AAGV Publisher Search Committee
July 9	Weekly GV Chair Status call
July 13	ICOAA Quarterly
July 14	Compliance Officer Meeting
July 15	Monthly Chairs Meeting
July 16	Publisher Interviews
July 21	Chairs trip to the General Service Office
	Finance Advisory Body Meeting
	GSO Staff Meeting
	Met with the board of the Mexican magazine <i>Plenitud</i>
July 22	Special GV Board Meeting
July 27	AAGV Strategic Planning Meeting
July 28	GV Publisher Interviews
July 29	AAGV Quarterly Board Meeting
July 30 – August 2	GSB Quarterly Meeting

Kathi Fowler

January – GSC Weekly meetings with Chris Cavanaugh, Acting Publisher

February 2	Meeting with AAGV and Wittkieber Consultants
February 9	ICOAA meeting
February 16	Ad-hoc background committee meeting on Censure
February 23	Recorded AAGV Board Chair Report for the GSC
March 2	Strategic Planning Committee
March 5	AAWS Board Meeting Observer
March 18	Election practice for GSC
March 19	AAGV Strategic Planning
March 20	AAGV Board Meeting
March 26	Joint meeting with Trustees' Conference Committee
March 30	Meeting to discuss shared services agreement
March 31	AAGV Publisher Search Committee
April 1	Joint meeting with AAGV Conference Committee
April 8	MC Albin Zezula Farewell Party
April 11	Review background for appeal
April 12	Audit Committee
	Farewell to retiring staff
April 13	Board Chairs Meeting
	Election Practice for GSC
April 14	AAGV Publisher Search Committee
April 21	AAGV Staff Meeting
April 17 – 24	Virtual General Service Conference
	Joint committee meetings
	AAGV Board meetings (2)
	GSB Board Meeting
April 28	AAGV Publisher Search Committee
May 1	Virtual GSB and AAGV Board Meetings
May 6	Meeting with Pacific Region Delegates
May 16	Met with General Service Trustee Paz Preciado

May 22	Special Board Meeting
June 3	Presentation on Concept 6
June 11 – 13	GSB Orientation
July 7	Virtual meeting with Pam Kosewick, Delegate Chair
July 8	Virtual meeting with Geene Delaplane, Report and Charter Conference Chair
	Virtual meeting with Pacific Regional Delegates
July 9	Virtual meeting with Caroline New, Policy and Admissions Conference Committee Chair
July 12	Virtual meeting with PRAASA Delegate Advisory Board
July 14	Beth Petitti, Agenda Conference Committee Chair
July 29	AAWS and AAGV Board meetings
July 30 – August 2	Virtual GSB Weekend

Francis Gilroy

February 3	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) Website Committee Meeting
February 4	Area 12, 28 & 29 (Delaware, Maine & Maryland) Service Manual Study
February 5 – 6	Southeast Regional Delegates Get-Together 2021
February 7	New England Conference of Young People in AA Advisory Meeting
February 7, 14, 21	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Committee Meeting
February 10	North America (US and Canada) Alternate Delegates Meeting
February 11	General Service Board Trustees Planning and Sharing Session
February 11, 17, 19	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Planning Committee Meeting
February 13	Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) Living Our 12 Concepts Meeting
February 18, 25	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) AA Service Manual Study
February 20	CPC/PI National Working Group
February 21	Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) Mid-Winter Luncheon
	Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Business Meeting
February 23	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
February 24	AA Grapevine, Inc. Employee Welfare Benefit Plan Meeting
February 25 – 28	Northeast Regional Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly Weekend
March 1	North America (US and Canada) Alternate Delegates Meeting
March 2	General Service Board Trustees Strategic Plan Work Session
March 4	Area 12, 28 & 29 (Delaware, Maine & Maryland) Service Manual Study
March 5	AAWS Board Meeting (Finance, Publishing, and Technology Committees)
March 9	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
March 10	Area Service Sharing Session – “ <i>Getting the Message Out</i> ” (3 Legacies)
March 11, 13	Northeast Regional Delegate’s Get-Together (and Planning) Meeting
March 13	Area 27 (Louisiana) “ <i>People Like Me</i> ” Workshop
March 14	Area 45 (Southern New Jersey) Annual Mini-Conference
March 15, 18	Area 50 (Western New York) Virtual Agenda Week (Pre-Conference)
March 19 – 20	Area 45 (Southern New Jersey) AA and AI-Anon Convention
	Area 61 (Rhode Island) State Convention (“ <i>AA in a Time of Change</i> ”)
March 20	AA Grapevine, Inc. Board Meeting
March 21	Area 46 (New Mexico) AA Grapevine and La Viña Writing Workshop
	Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Business Meeting
March 23	Northeast Regional Trustee Delegates Orientation (Conference Planning)
March 23	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting

March 25	"Stepping Stones" Archive Highlights on Marty M. (and Workshop)
March 27	Area 30 Literature Committee " <i>Explaining Changes to AA Literature</i> " ACYPAA (All California Young People) 2021 Conference
March 28	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) Grapevine Committee Meeting
March 30	Joint Trustees-Conference Committee on Finance and Budget Meeting
March 31	General Service Conference Virtual Protocols and Technical Training
March 31, April 7	AA Grapevine Publisher Search Committee Meeting
April 1	Joint Trustees-Conference Committee on AA Grapevine Meeting North America (US and Canada) Alternate Delegates Meeting
April 3	Area 13 (District of Columbia) Annual Mini-Conference Area 61 (Rhode Island) Service Committee of YPAA (Hybrid Format)
April 4	Area 15 (South Florida, et al) " <i>Learning to Apply Robert's Rules of Order</i> "
April 5	Area 61 (Rhode Island) Pre-Conference Topic, Roundtables and Surveys
April 6, 8	General Service Conference Virtual Protocols and Technical Training
April 7, 13	ad hoc General Manager and Affiliates Committee Meeting
April 10 – 11	Area 43 (New Hampshire) Convention – " <i>A New Vision for the Future</i> "
April 10	Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) Mini-Conference Area 29 (Maryland) Mini-Conference Various Areas, GSO Staff and Others " <i>Another Day of AA</i> " Workshop
April 11	Area 45 (Southern New Jersey) DCM Round Table Area 43 (New Hampshire) YPAA " <i>Not a Glum Lot</i> " Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) Pre-Conference Assembly Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Business Meeting
April 12	Trustees Audit Committee Meeting - Post-Audit Presentation
April 14, 28	AA Grapevine Publisher Search Committee Meeting
April 17	General Service Conference 1728 and Remote Communities Meetings
April 18 – 25	71st General Service Conference
April 20	AA Grapevine, Inc. and AA World Services, Inc. Sharing Session
April 27	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
May 1	Second Quarterly Meeting of the Trustees and Members of the GSB Grapevine Board post-GSB Meeting
May 4, 26	AA Grapevine Publisher Search Committee Meeting
May 7, 12, 19, 21	Northeast Regional Forum Host Committee Planning Meeting
May 8	Area 50 (Western New York) 10 th Annual Archives Breakfast
May 8	Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) Living Our 12 Concepts Meeting
May 11	General Service Board's Financial Advisory Body Meeting
May 12	AA Grapevine Board Preamble Discussion Area Service Sharing Session – Theme: " <i>Service is the Secret</i> "
May 15	North/South Connections Special Forum – " <i>The Hand of AA</i> "
May 16	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) Post-Conference Assembly Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Business Meeting
May 17	GSB Treasurer and IRS Form 990 Tax Organizer Overview
May 18, 21	Trustees Orientation Planning (Finance and Fiduciary Presentations)
May 20	Area 12, 28 & 29 (Delaware, Maine & Maryland) Service Manual Study
May 22	General Service Board Special Meeting (General Manager Search)
May 23	Area 11 (Connecticut) Spring (Post-Conference) Assembly Area 15 (South Florida, et al) " <i>Accessibility for All Alcoholics</i> "
May 26, 27	Northeast Regional Forum Host Committee Planning Meeting
May 30	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) Grapevine Committee Meeting

June 1	Meeting with AA Grapevine Publisher (Financials and IRS 990 Filing) North America (US and Canada) Alternate Delegates Meeting Trustees Orientation Planning " <i>Who Killed my Agenda Item?</i> "
June 2, 3	Northeast Regional Forum / Host Committee Planning Meeting
June 2, 16, 30	AA Grapevine Publisher Search Committee Meeting
June 2	Area 19 (Chicago) Post-Conference Delegate Report and Presentation
June 3	Area 12, 28 & 29 (Delaware, Maine & Maryland) Concepts Workshop
June 4 – 6	Northeast Regional Forum
June 7	Meeting with GSB Chair (General Sharing Session Topics)
June 8	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
June 11 – 13	General Service Board Incoming Trustees Orientation
June 14	Meeting with Staff Coordinator (General Sharing Session Topics)
June 16	General Service Board's Financial Advisory Body Meeting Trustees Nominating Committee
June 18	Area 49 (Southeast New York) Finance: " <i>Where Does the Money Go?</i> "
June 19	Area 50 (Western New York) Post-Conference Assembly
June 20	Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Business Meeting
June 21	Area 49 (Southeast New York) Concept VI Workshop w/Trustee Emerita
June 25 – 26	AA Grapevine, Inc. New Board Members Orientation and Board Meeting
June 27	Nassau County General Service (Area 49) 36 th Annual Unity Breakfast
July 1	North America (US and Canada) Alternate Delegates Meeting
July 7, 16, 21	AA Grapevine Publisher Search Committee Meeting
July 12	GSB Weekend Structure (General Sharing Session and 1728 Format)
July 13	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
July 18	Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Business Meeting
July 19	Area 49 (Southeast New York) Concept VII Workshop w/Trustee Emerita
July 21	General Service Board's Financial Advisory Body Meeting (Hybrid)
July 24	Area 11 (Connecticut) 20 th " <i>Rompiendo Fronteras</i> " (Breaking Frontiers)
July 25	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) Grapevine Committee Meeting
July 28	AA Grapevine Publisher Search Committee Wrap-up Meeting
July 29 – 30	AAWS / AAGV Board Meeting
July 31 – August 2	3 rd Quarter General Service Board Weekend

Tom Hoban

May 12	Area Service Sharing Session
May 15	North/South Connections Forum
May 16	Georgia State Service Assembly
May 22	Executive Session Board meeting - Selection of GM
May 23	Louisiana Area Assembly
June 2	Southern States A.A. Service Assembly (SSAASA) Planning meeting
June 4 – 6	Northeast Regional Forum
June 11 – 13	Trustee Orientation
June 24	Dashboard tutorial
June 25	AAGV Board meeting
July 12	Trustees' Corrections Committee meeting
July 14	Southeast Delegates Get-Together Planning meeting SSAASA Planning meeting

July 17	Georgia Department of Corrections Volunteer Training (In Person)
July 22	Trustees' Correction Committee meeting
July 31 – August 2	General Service Board Weekend

Judith Ann Karam

Feb. 5, 12, 19, 26	Ad Hoc GM Search Committee
February 16	AAWS Interim Role
February 17	AAWS Info Sharing Session
February 22	AAWS Internal Audit
March 2	GSB Strategic Plan Trustee Work Session
March 3	Trip Consultation Team
March 5	AAWS Board Meeting
March 11, 18, 26	GSB, GM Search Committee
March 9, 17, 19	AAWS IAC
March 10	AA Material/Allendale– David Rosen
March 20	AA Grapevine Board Meeting
March 23 – 24	AAWS IAC
March 31	Publisher Search Committee
March 30	AA GSB Trustee Finance Committee
April 6, 9, 14, 16	GSB Ad Hoc GM Search Committee
April 7	Trip Consultation Team
April 7,14,28	AAWS Publisher Search Committee
April 8	Albin Zezula Farewell Party
April 12	Farewell to rotating trustees - a Jimmy/Jan production - Latest FYI
April 17 – 24	AA Conference week
April 20	Joint AAWS and AAGV Joint Meeting
April 21	GSB Ad Hoc GM Search Committee
May 1	AAWS Board Meeting
May 5, 26	AAGV Publisher Search Committee
May 15	North/South Connections Forum - AA Reg. Class A Panel
May 22	Special General Services Board Meeting
June 2, 16, 30	AAGV Publisher Search Committee
June 4	Trip Consultation Team
June 18	AA Regional Meeting
June 21	Trip Consultation Committee
July 1	AAGV Search Committee Interviews

Deborah Koltai

May 11	Finance Advisory Board (FAB)
	ICOAA Quarterly Meeting
May 22	GSB special meeting
May 25	AAWS Board/Exec Management Info Sharing Session
May 28	ICOAAO Full Meeting
June 7	AAWS Self-Support Subcommittee
June 11 – 13	Trustees' Orientation
June 25	AAWS Board Meeting
July 6	Meeting about NetSuite-Webstore problems
July 8	AAWS Self-Support Subcommittee
	AAWS Nominating Committee

July 9	ICOAA Manager Meeting
July 27	AAWS Nominating Committee Meeting
July 29	AAWS Board Meeting
July 30 – August 2	GSB Quarterly Meeting

Trish LaNauze

February 2	Services Touchpoint Meeting
February 4	Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting
February 5	Search Committee Meeting
	Temuco Gathering (Chile)
	North/South Planning Meeting in Argentina
February 6	Temuco Gathering (Chile)
February 9	Trustees PI Committee Meeting -PSAs and pamphlets
February 11	Trustees Planning Meeting
February 12	Orientation Committee
	Search Committee Meeting
Feb. 12 – 13	Asia-Oceania Service Meeting / Policy, Admission, Finance Committee
February 16	Services Touchpoint Meeting
February 18	Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting
	North/South Planning Meeting in Argentina
February 21	Western Region Meeting
February 22	North/South Internal Planning Meeting
	Phone Meeting with PI Secretary
February 24	Orientation Committee Meeting
February 25	North/South Planning – Agenda Committee – Argentina
	REDELA
February 26	Search Committee Meeting
	Western Canada Regional Service Assembly
February 27	WRAASA and Romania 30 th Anniversary
March 1	PI – ACM Resume Review
March 2	Strategic Plan Work Session
	Services Touchpoint Meeting
March 3	International: Trip Consultation Team
March 4	Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting
March 5	AAWS Meeting
March 7	Women's Meeting in Argentina
March 8	Women's Meeting in Argentina
	North/South Internal Planning Meeting
March 9	PI – ACM Interviews
March 10	Orientation Committee Meeting
	PI-ACM Interviews
March 11	Search Committee Meeting
	REDELA Policy, Admission, Finance Committee Meeting
March 12	PI – ACM Meetings
March 16	PI – CMP Meeting
	Joint Conference/Trustees Corrections Meeting
	Services Touchpoint Meeting
March 17	Phone call with Conference PI Committee Chair
March 18	Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting
	Search Committee Meeting

March 19 Joint Conference/Trustees PI Committee Meeting
 PI – ACMs Meetings
 Buddy Assignments Working Group
 REDELA – PAF Meeting
 North/South Connections Meeting in Argentina
 Japan Conference
 March 20 Grapevine
 Area 78 Remote Communities
 March 21 NERD Meeting
 March 22 North/South Internal Planning Meeting
 March 24 Orientation Committee Meeting
 March 25 North/South Internal/Roles Meeting
 REDELA
 March 26 Search Committee Meeting
 March 28 Western Region Meeting
 March 29 North/South Internal Meeting
 March 30 Services Touchpoint Meeting
 March 31 North/South Internal Meeting
 April 1 Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting
 April 2 North/South Planning in Argentina
 April 3 North Shore Round Up Service Panel
 April 5 North/South Internal Meeting
 Joint North/South Meeting Argentina and Internal
 Vancouver Intergroup Town Hall
 April 6 Search Committee Interviews
 April 7 Orientation Committee Meeting
 Trip Consultation Team Meeting
 AA Around the World Presentation: Dist. 18/Mon. Night West
 Vancouver Group
 April 8 REDELA – PAF Meeting
 April 9 Search Committee Interviews
 North/South Planning Meeting in Argentina
 April 9 – 11 Area 79 Pre-Conference Assembly
 April 12 Farewell to Rotating Trustees
 April 13 Search Committee: GM candidate interview
 April 15 Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting
 April 16 Search Committee: GM Candidate Interview
 North/South Planning Meeting in Argentina
 April 17 – 24 71st General Service Conference
 April 26 North/South Internal Planning Meeting
 April 29 Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting
 REDELA
 April 30 North/South Joint teams meetings
 May 1 General Service Board Meeting
 May 2 Western Canada Region Meeting
 May 3 North South Internal Planning Meeting
 May 5 Orientation Committee Meeting
 May 6 North/South Moderator and Panelists check-in
 May 8 North /South Mock Session
 May 10 North/South Internal Meeting
 May 12 North/South Program walk-through

May 13	Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting REDELA- PAF Meeting
May 14	North/South Planning Meeting in Argentina
May 15	North/South Connections event
May 19	Orientation Committee Meeting
May 20	Search Committee Meeting
May 22	Special Board Meeting
May 25	North/South Debriefing
May 26	Orientation Committee Meeting
May 27	Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting REDELA
May 30	Western Region Meeting
June 1	Orientation skit rehearsal and taping North/South event de-brief with Argentina
June 2	Orientation Committee Meeting
June 4	Trip Consultation Team Meeting
June 4 – 6	Northeast Regional Forum
June 8	Orientation Tech run-through
June 10	Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting
June 11 – 13	Trustees' Orientation
June 16	Nominating Committee Meeting re: Class A Trustees
June 17	REDELA PAF Meeting
June 21	Trip Consultation Team Meeting Inter-Area Remote Communities Meeting – North/South Report
June 23	Orientation Committee Meeting De-brief
June 24	Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting REDELA PAF Meeting
June 25	AAWS Meeting
June 26	AA Grapevine Meeting
June 27	TAL Orientation
July 8	Trustee at Large /Int'l Desk Meeting
July 9 – 11	Area 79 Quarterly
July 13	Trip Consultation Team
July 18	Western Region Meeting
July 22	REDELA
July 26	Meeting with Int'l desk to go through agenda
July 29	AAWS Meeting
July 31 – August 2	General Service Board Meeting

Jan Lembke

February 9	Eastern Canada Delegates' Orientation Committee Mtg.
February 11	Trustees' Planning & Sharing
February 16	A.A.W.S. Board Mtg (Interim GM)
February 17	Mtg with EC Delegate A.A.W.S. Info Sharing
February 23	Eastern Canada Delegates' Orientation Committee Mtg
February 24	Trustees' Orientation Committee
February 25	A.A.W.S. Nominating
February 27	Eastern Canada Delegates' Orientation Day
March 2	GSB Strategic Planning Session

March 5	A.A.W.S. Board
March 6	Trustees Farewell Planning Committee
	Eastern Canada Delegates' Orientation Wrap Up
March 10	Trustees' Orientation Committee
March 16	Corrections Joint Meeting
March 19	Trustees Buddy Meeting
March 31	GSC Zoom Training
April 2	Trustees Farewell Planning Committee
April 5	TNC & CTC Joint Meeting
April 6	Mock GSC Training
April 8	Albin's Farewell
April 1	TNC Meeting re: appeal
April 12	Trustees' Farewell
April 13	A.A.W.S. Board – new GM interview
April 16	A.A.W.S. Board – new GM interview
April 17 – 24	71 st General Service Conference
April 20	A.A.W.S. Board – GM debrief
April 21	A.A.W.S. Board – farewell
May 1	GSB Meeting
May 5	Trustees' Orientation Committee
May 7	Meeting with Trustee – orientation
May 8	Area 86 ACM (observer only to hear Delegate report)
May 8	Area 83 ACM (observer only to hear Delegate report)
May 11	Recording message to Area 87
May 12	Meeting with Trustee Buddy
May 13	Meeting with TNC Staff assistant
May 15	North/South Connection Form
May 19	Trustees' Orientation Committee
May 22	GSB – GM Candidates' Interviews
May 28 – 30	Area 82 Assembly
June 1	Trustees' Orientation Skit Rehearsal
June 2	Trustees' Orientation Committee
June 3 – 6	NE Regional Forum (observer only)
June 7	Canadian Employment Sub Committee Meeting
June 11 – 13	Trustees' Orientation
June 14	Meeting with TNC Staff assistant
June 15	Meeting with GSB Chair
June 16	TNC Welcome Meeting + Orientation for Class A Process
June 23	Trustees' Orientation Committee Wrap Up
June 25	A.A.W.S. Board Mtg (Observer only)
July 5	Mtg with TNC Secretary – set agenda
July 12	Corrections Mtg
July 21	Mtg with CTC Delegate Chair
July 22	Corrections Mtg
July 26	CERAASA mtg with Region
July 27	Mtg with TNC Secretary – working agenda
July 29	A.A.W.S. Board Mtg (Observer only)
July 30 – August 2	GSB Weekend

Mike Lewis

Feb 25	Regional Delegates Meeting – Chair
March 1	Minority Participation Ad Hoc Committee – Committee Member North America Alternate Delegates Meeting – Observer
March 2	GSB Strategic Planning Trustee Work Session
March 16	Joint Meeting Trustees' and Conference Committee on Corrections – Participant
March 20	AAGV Board Meeting – Observer
March 27	Joint Meeting Trustees' and Conference Committee on Literature – Participant
March 30	West Central Regional Trustee Delegate Orientation
March 31	AAGV Publisher Search Committee Meeting
April 7	AAGV Publisher Search Committee Meeting
April 12	Farewell to Rotating Trustee
April 14	AAGV Publisher Search Committee Meeting
April 17	Remote Communities Meeting
April 18 – 24	71st General Service Conference
April 28	AAGV Publisher Search Committee Meeting
May 1	GSB Second Quarterly Board Meeting
May 5	AAGV Publisher Search Committee Meeting
May 12	AAGV Preamble Discussion
May 13	3 Legacies Group – Speaker
May 15	North/South Connections Forum – Observer
May 22	Special GSB Meeting
May 24	West Central Regional Delegates Meeting
May 26	AAGV Publisher Search Committee Meeting
June 1	North America Alternate Delegate Meeting – Observer
June 2	AAGV Publisher Search Committee Meeting
June 3	2021 Virtual Northeast Regional Forum Touchpoint Meeting
June 7	AAWS Self-Support Subcommittee
June 11 – 13	GSB Orientation
June 16	AAGV Publisher Search Committee Meeting
June 25	AAGV New Director's Orientation
June 26	AAGV Board Meeting
June 28	West Central Regional Delegates Meeting
June 30	AAGV Publisher Search Committee Meeting
July 1	North America Alternate Delegates Meeting
July 7	Beacon Group – Noon Step Meeting – Speaker
July 8	AAWS Self-Support Subcommittee –
July 12	Trustees Corrections Committee – Chair
July 16	AAGV Publisher Search Committee – Interviews
July 20	AAGV Strategic Planning Committee Meeting
July 22	AAGV Special Board Meeting Trustees Corrections Committee – Chair
July 26	West Central Regional Delegates Meeting
July 27	AAGV Strategic Planning Committee
July 28	AAGV Board Interview
July 29	AAGV Board Meeting
July 31 – August 2	General Service Board Weekend

Nancy McCarthy

February 11	GSB Board Meeting
March 2	GSB Strategic Planning Meeting
March 5	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting (visitor)
March 7	Trustee/Conference Committee Meeting
March 16	Joint Conference/Trustee Correction Committee Meeting
March 19	GSB Strategic Planning Committee Meeting
March 20	GV Board Meeting
March 27	Joint Conference/Trustee Literature Committee Meeting
March 31	AAGV E.E. Search Committee Meeting
April 1	Joint Conference/Trustee GV
April 7	AAGV E.E. Search Committee Meeting
April 8	Farewell party for GV Executive Editor
April 10	Area 87 Assembly
April 12	Farewell for rotating trustees
April 14	AAGV E.E. Search Committee Meeting

Kevin Prior

<i>May 1 – Aug 2</i>	<i>Approximately 20 calls with Acting Class A Board Buddy, Class B Board Buddy, Past Trustees, Current Trustees and Staff</i>
May 1	General Service Board Meeting
May 7	Introductory Call with CFO
May 11	Finance Advisory Board (FAB)
May 12	Introductory Call with Regional Forums Coordinator
May 17	Discussion with Board Secretary on Investment Policy for Reserve Fund
	Transition Call with immediate past GSB Chair
	Transition Call with immediate past GSB Treasurer
May 26	Trustee Buddy Orientation
May 27	Call with CFO to Finalize Finance Presentation for Northeast Regional Forum
May 29	General Manager Interviews
June 2	Introductory Call with Assistant Director of Finance
June 3	Northeast Regional Forum Planning Discussion and Sound Check
June 4 – 6	Northeast Regional Forum
June 10	Call with CFO and Assistant Director of Finance – Feedback on Northeast Regional Forum Finance Presentation
June 11 – 13	General Service Board Trustees Orientation
June 16	FAB Meeting
	Introductory Call with Conference Finance Chair
June 23	Discussion with CFO on Fund Governance Policies
	Onboarding/orientation dinner with Class B “Board Buddy” and Acting Class A Trustee
June 25	AAWS Board Meeting
July 9	Call with CFO and Assistant Director Finance – Trustees Finance Committee Meeting Planning and Agenda
July 14	Compliance Officers and HR Meeting
July 29	Background/Training Discussion with Predecessor Treasurers
July 21	FAB Meeting
July 27	Pre-Trustees Finance Committee Call with Conference Finance Chair
July 28	Call with CFO and Assistant Director of Finance – Trustees Finance

Committee and GSB Finance Report and Sharing Sessions Final
Planning

July 29 AAWS Board and Finance Committee Meeting
July 30 – August 2 GSB Quarterly Meeting

Marita Rhinehart

May 1 Post GS Conference Board Meeting
May 3 Area 42 North Service Manual Study
May 4 Class A Trustee FB Page Discussion w/ Nancy McCarthy (phone mtg.)
Area 09 Concept Study – Concept 5
May 13 Trustees-at-Large with Intl Desk Staff bi-weekly Mtg
May 15 North-South Connection (Intl Remote Communities)
May 16 Area 05 Spring Assembly with Report Back
May 22 Additional General Service Board Meeting
May 27 Trustees-at-Large with Intl Desk staff Mtg
REDELA Delegates' monthly Mtg.
June 4 Trip Consultation Team Mtg
June 4 – 6 Northeast Regional Forum – guest
June 5 Area 42 South intro and report
June 10 Trustees-at-Large with Intl Desk Staff bi-weekly Mtg
Board Events Steering Committee Mtg
June 11 Board Orientation
June 12 Board Orientation
June 13 Board Orientation
June 21 Trip Consultation Team Mtg
June 24 Trustees-at-Large with Intl Desk Staff bi-weekly Mtg
REDELA Delegates' monthly Mtg
June 26 Group Inventory Facilitator – on-line group structure questions
June 27 Past Trustees-at-Large Sharing Session & Orientation
July 1 Board Events Steering Committee Mtg
July 7 Facilitate On-Line Women's Group Inventory
July 8 Trustees-at-Large with Intl Desk Staff bi-weekly Mtg
July 12 Corrections Comm Agenda Items Discussion
July 13 Trip Consultation Committee Mtg
July 14 Area 79 District Mtg Speaker with Beau Bush
July 15 Board Events Steering Committee Mtg
July 22 Trustees-at-Large with Intl Desk Staff bi-weekly Mtg
Monthly REDELA Mtg
Corrections Comm Agenda Items Discussion
July 23 North/ South II Regional Forum
July 29 AAWS Quarterly Board Mtg. (Observer)
July 31 – August 2 General Service Board Weekend

Irma Van De Bon-Nicol

February 7 WRAASA Committee Meeting
February 8 Meeting with Area 80 Archives
Phone Meeting with Trustee Buddy
February 11 Trustees Planning and Sharing Meeting
February 14 Concepts Study

	WRAASA Committee Meeting
February 17	Trustees Orientation Committee Meeting
February 21	WRAASA Committee Meeting
February 19 – 21	International Women's Conference
February 21	Western Canada Regional Meeting
February 24	Trustees Orientation Committee Meeting
	WRAASA mock and trial run
February 25, 26	WRAASA/ WRAASA Chairperson
March 2	Trustees Orientation Committee Meeting
March 5	AAWS Board Meeting (attended as an observer)
	PRAASA 2021
March 6	PRAASA 2021
March 10	Trustees Orientation Committee Meeting
March 14	WRAASA Committee Meeting and wrap up
March 18	Joint meeting of the trustees' C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities and the Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.
March 19	Buddy Assignments Sub Committee Meeting
March 19, 20	Area 91 Spring Assembly
March 22	Speaker Meeting (my story and service journey)
March 23	Regional Delegate Orientation for Conference
March 24	Trustees Orientation Committee Meeting
March 26 – 28	Area 80 Spring Assembly
April 1	Joint C.P.C Conference Committee and Trustees Committee Meeting
April 6	Mock Conference Training Session
April 7	Trustees Orientation Committee Meeting
April 9 – 11	Area 79 Preconference Assembly
April 12	Trustees Farewell
April 17 – 24	General Service Conference
April 20	AAWS/AAGV Joint Sharing Session
May 5	Trustees Orientation Committee Meeting
May 7	A.A.W.S. IAC Executive Session
	Phone Meeting re. Nominations Committee
May 10	GSB Gratitude Video
May 13	Phone Meeting GSB Chair
May 15	North South Connection Forum
May 17	Trustees Orientation/3 Board Chair interview planning meeting
May 19	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting
	Trustee Buddy Meeting
May 20	A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee Meeting
	Concept Study-presented Concept 1 and sharing session
May 22	GSB Special Meeting
May 25	A.A.W.S./AAGV Joint Sharing Session
May 30	Western Canada Regional Meeting
June 1	It's All in the Relationships- Orientation Meeting
	Trustee orientation Skit practise and recording
	A.A.W.S. IAC Committee Meeting
June 2	Trustee Orientation Committee Meeting
June 4 – 6	Northeast Regional Forum
June 11 – 13	Trustee Orientation
June 19	The History of A.A. in the Western Canada Region
June 25	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting

July 8	A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee Meeting
July 9	A.A.W.S. IAC Committee Meeting
July 18	Western Canada Regional Meeting
July 27	A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee Meeting
July 29	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting
July 30 – August 2	General Service Board Weekend

PENDING APPROVAL

General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

May 22, 2021 via Video Conference

The Trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. (GSB), upon call of the Chair of the Board for a special Board meeting, met on May 22, 2021 with Linda Chezem, J.D. presiding.

The meeting was called to order at 12 p.m.

Present: Molly Anderson; Beau Bush; Hon. Christine Carpenter; Cathi Clark; Jimmy Dean; Josh Eggleston; Kathryn Fowler; Francis H. Gilroy; Tom Hoban; Sister Judith Ann Karam, CSA; Deborah Koltai; Patricia LaNauze; Jan Lembke; Mike Lewis; Nancy J. McCarthy; Al J. Mooney, M.D.; Paz Preciado; Kevin Prior, MBA, CFA, CPA; Marita Rhinehart; and Irma Van De Bon-Nicol.

Also Present: Donna Padilla, from the consulting firm of WittKieffer, and Mike Wilson, Technical Director.

Following a motion and second, the minutes of the Second Quarterly Meeting of the Trustees and Members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., held on May 1, 2021 were approved as presented.

Jimmy Dean, GSB General Manager (GM) Ad Hoc Search Committee Chair, introduced the members of the Search Committee and welcomed Donna Padilla, consultant. Together, Jimmy and Donna outlined a chronology of significant events as well as the methodology employed to evaluate the 14 initial candidates for the GM position.

After responding to some clarifying questions from the GSB, Donna withdrew from the virtual room and the Board went into executive session at 1:00 p.m.

Consistent with the provisions of Nominating Procedure No. 9, Guidelines for Hiring General Manager, G.S.O., the GSB proceeded to conduct thoughtful interviews of the Search Committee's final two GM candidates.

Then, an extensive dialogue commenced, including but not limited to, the GSB GM Search Committee's Final Report; the Summary of A.A.W.S. Board Discussion of GM Candidates; the GM Direct Reports Meetings with GM Candidates (i.e., interview guide and cover letter); as well as the GSB's own interviews.

By substantial unanimity, Bob Wilcox was elected our new General Manager, G.S.O.

Subsequently, a resolution to fully support our incoming GM passed unanimously.

The meeting was adjourned at 6:00 p.m.

A.A. World Services, Inc.

March – July 2021

Jimmy Dean, Chair

Since its January 2021 meeting, the A.A. World Services (A.A.W.S.) Corporate Board has met five times: March 5, April 21, May 1, June 25 and July 29. During this same period, the A.A.W.S. Finance, Publishing, Technology/Communication/Services and Internal Audit committees each met three times. Additionally, the A.A.W.S. and AA Grapevine boards met in an informal joint session during Conference week in April 2021.

STAFF SERVICES

Accessibilities/LIM

The staff secretary continues passing along the shared experience available on the Accessibilities Committee Service web page as well as in the assignment's digital files. The Remote Communities Service page will soon be available on the aa.org website. The page will include relevant literature and useful links for service work.

Conference

The second virtual General Service Conference generated 49 Advisory Actions. The separate annual two-hour Post-Conference Sharing Session and Implementation Meetings provided specific insight into what went well at the Conference and what areas have room for improvement as well as ensuring that all 71st G.S.C. Advisory Actions have been reviewed and that appropriate implementation is planned. The hope is for continued improvements and key changes to make things better. The Conference desk is preparing a communication to inform of the new deadline for proposed agenda items from December 15 to September 15.

Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment

Due to the Covid-19 pandemic GSO has not participated in live or virtual exhibits. We look forward to the reopening of the country and have requested exhibit materials for August 2021. Class A trustee Nancy McCarthy spoke at the CPC Virtual Workshop and CPC staff assisted with the Q&A portion of event. Staff attended the NIAAA Virtual Roundtable in June and several area assemblies throughout July. The Treatment desk continues to answer letters from persons in treatment and to send A.A. materials, having received letters back stating how valuable this material was to those in treatment and to their sobriety.

Corrections

In August 2020, the Corrections assignment embarked on the daunting task of overhauling the outdated Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS) database system. In collaboration with the Technical Services department and an outside consultant firm, the Corrections staff coordinator and the team assigned to the project meet weekly to discuss, brainstorm, strategize and iron out outstanding issues from the old database system to the new state-of-the-art digital application. The new CCS Matching Application, set to launch in September 2021, will automatically match insiders and outsiders by gender, language, miles (not region) and country. The application will enable personalized welcome letters to be sent to all participants with information of their match along with instructions on how the system works. In addition, the system will give the ability to pull reports on the total number of active and inactive participants, participants matched, people waiting to be matched, and any missing information from inmate and participant records. The Corrections desk will receive an alert when there is no available match for an insider. This allows

the staff member to immediately reach out to a Bridging the Gap committee chair for assistance. After implementation of the new CCS Matching App, it is anticipated that phase two will revise functionality and fix or add features as needed.

Group Services

Three official Fellowship Connection sharing sessions via videoconference were conducted. The desk has received a high volume of communication regarding the 2021 Advisory Action pertaining to online groups. There are many concerns with the practicality of how listing will work both at the office and locally with registrars. Group Services is part of the GSO working group recently formed to help implement the Advisory Action. Group services meets with OIAA monthly. Most of the established groups in OIAA that participate in the joint meeting prefer a “virtual area” or “virtual district” and feel strained by the current Advisory Action. They also feel like a virtual DCM and or delegate would understand them as some have never been to an in-person meeting, and this is not something they started as a result of a pandemic.

International

The pan-transcontinental North/South Connections Forum was held on May 15, 2021, with participation from members in the far southern regions of Argentina, Chile and the far northern regions of the U.S. and Canada. The theme was “Carrying the A.A. Message Despite Distances and Beyond Borders,” with sharing on “What Was the Beginning of Your Remote Communities Group Like?” “Strengths-Weaknesses-Distances: How We Practice the Twelfth Step -- Can the A.A. Service Structure Help?” and sharing about getting sober in a remote community. As one speaker shared, “It was a great demonstration of unity. Our flag is A.A.”

Literature

The Literature Desk has followed up 21 proposed agenda item submissions to share about the actions stemming from the 71st General Service Conference as well as following up with GSO Publishing about the nine Advisory Actions and nine Committee Considerations that are pertinent to the department and stem from the Conference Committee on Literature. These follow ups have coincided with preparation of draft agendas and background materials for the upcoming meetings of the A.A.W.S. Publishing and trustees’ Literature Committees.

Nominating

Work has begun to fill the 2022 vacancies for Class A trustees, and this year an announcement was posted to the LinkedIn page. An inquiry was sent out to previous Class A candidates inviting them to reapply. Other vacancy announcement letters were sent out within the Fellowship to fill the 2022 Class B trustee positions from the Eastern Canada and Pacific regions. Cooperation is in progress with the two corporate boards on filling vacancies for nontrustee director and/or general service trustee.

Public Information

In 2021 three press releases have been distributed by Cision PR Newswire. Tapping into Cision’s expertise, GSO is contracted to do up to six press releases in 2021 with Cision and has the potential to build its own media lists from them. With each press release we are receiving full visibility reports to gain a better understanding of our reach, target audiences, and to learn more about the public’s interest in A.A. and how we can be helpful. Separately, the 2021 Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media was also distributed by Cision and for the first time some news outlets including the Associated Press and Yahoo Finance shared the memo with the public.

Regional Forums

Immediately following the General Service Conference, the staff member on this assignment

joined in planning the May 15 virtual North/South Connection to gain experience in preparing for the virtual Special Forum in December 2021. The staff member also coordinated the first virtual Northeast Regional Forum held on June 4-6, 2021. Experience from these two virtual events will greatly inform the discussions and preparations for the remaining three virtual forums in 2021.

Note: Several GSO staff members have rotated on to another assignment as of July 29.

OFFICE MANAGEMENT

The new general manager, Robert (Bob) Wilcox, started Tuesday, June 1. He attended the Asia-Oceania Service Meeting and the Al-Anon 70th Anniversary Celebration, citing the impressive virtual flag ceremony.

On Wednesday, July 21, Linda Chezem, GSB chair, Jimmy Dean, A.A.W.S. chair and Josh Eggleston, AAGV chair, traveled to GSO. After the long period of lockdowns, they wanted to express their gratitude and support in person to all the employees of the office. Although the office is still operating virtually, over 50 employees arrived and worked in the office that day, many for the first time since March 2020. The three chairs attended a Finance Advisory Body Meeting, an "All Employee Huddle," where each shared their gratitude for the office and the Fellowship. After lunch, they participated in the Wednesday afternoon GSO Staff Meeting where all in attendance shared openly on how to harness the operational principles embodied within the Concepts, Traditions and Steps in order to best work together, increase participation and strengthen our group conscience. This was truly a historic event that can be summarized with one word, unity!

Administration:

Return to the Workplace

Limited voluntary return began May 3, 2021, by which employees can come in to work at the GSO. During the limited voluntary return period, both the Interchurch Center and the GSO/ Grapevine offices continue to require mask wearing in common areas and encourage social distancing and frequent hand washing. The full return to the workplace, with some work from home eligibility is set to begin October 1, 2021. The Human Resources department collaborated with the senior leadership team to assess job roles for eligibility to work from home 1-3 days per week and qualifying employees were notified of their eligibility. The Return to the Workplace Taskforce has invited back an epidemiologist to share any workplace trends and to help address employee questions including questions on the Delta variant.

Canadian Employment

It was brought to the attention of the General Service Board chair during the GM search process that a clear policy regarding the employment of Canadian citizens was needed. It was discussed that such a policy would have significance on both a practical and a spiritual level, acknowledging the important role of Canadian members in the U.S./Canada service structure. A motion was made and seconded that the GSB affirms that all employment opportunities offered by A.A.W.S. or AAGV include Canadian citizens and will explore the best path forward to accommodate legal and/or other requirements. An initial meeting was held on June 7 and a working group formed to explore the best path forward.

Archives: From January through mid-July, the Archives staff responded to approximately 550 inquiries. The associate archivist continues to listen to recordings of past General Service

Conferences to develop a comprehensive catalog in Archives database Re:Discovery. A Laserfiche training manual was developed, providing tips on how to search for information in Laserfiche and guidelines around use. Last year, Archives posed the idea of creating a poster to commemorate the virtual 2020 International Convention and in June it became available to groups and members. For every International Convention, a panoramic image is captured, beginning with the first convention in 1950. Currently, the department is assisting South Africa with their anniversary celebration by providing historical information related to A.A. in that country. A.A. in South Africa is celebrating 75 years, and the local members are putting together a series of events to commemorate the Jubilee celebration starting October 2021.

Human Resources: We have fully transitioned to BRI as an administrator of not only our FSA and other pre-tax benefits, but our HRA and COBRA payments and reimbursements as well. This will streamline processing and provide faster turnaround and better customer service for our employees and retirees. As of May 1, 2021, Paduano and Weintraub are our new employment counsel. Our primary contact Meredith Cavallaro leads the employment team and is well-respected throughout the New York City area in supporting employers to minimize risk and avoid litigation. SmithPilot was selected as our new compensation consultant to support a full review of organization-wide compensation this summer.

Operations: For a time, Fellowship Connection (FC) paused further enhancements so the taskforce could survey registrars for a deeper assessment of their needs to ensure the Fellowship is provided with what they want and need. The internal FC working group conducted three sharing sessions with area registrars on May 6, May 11 and May 26. The first quarterly sharing session with the area registrars was held Monday, July 26. Again, these sessions help to get input and feedback from the registrars as we continue to enhance and roll out future releases of Fellowship Connection.

The new Member and Customer Service department officially launched June 28, 2021. In April the team began training on all area of Records, Order Entry, Order Inquiry and the customer service portion of Contributions. Each associate has access to an app that is installed on their cell phone and allows the Member and Customer Service direct line (212-870-3023) to display on the customer's phone when receiving a call from the Member and Customer Service team at GSO. The team is also utilizing a customer communication platform system which combines the simplicity of email with the intelligence of a CRM (customer relationship management) to improve the customer experience. This system is improving overall email efficiency helping to manage and organize the shared inbox (memberandcustomerservice@aa.org) and allows the manager to better support workflow.

Technology Services: The Technology Services team continues to play a critical role on the ERP Project, including:

- Overall program and project management across the multiple workstreams, including the upgrade of Vertex and restoration of native NetSuite tax functionality;
- RSM vendor management;
- Participation in sharing sessions with area registrars;
- Documenting functional requirements for Fellowship Connection, and the Webstore and Contributions modules; and
- Data-mining and data clean-up to support production issue resolution, e.g. identification of missing kits and information necessary to get them ordered.

Technology Services is improving our cyber and data security. The team completed implementing Bitlocker (Windows OS) and File Vault (Mac) to encrypt the hard-drives of all laptops and remotely-deployed desktops. The department also began cybersecurity testing and

training for GSO via KnowBe4, executing a baseline phishing test and a first round of training that was completed by all employees.

The TS team also played a role in the preparation and training for the new Member and Customer Service department, including creating the new roles in ERP and supporting the training. Driving the design and development of Front to assist Member and Customer Service with email management. The TS team is playing a significant role managing the new aa.org development project, including managing the development vendor, identifying a hosting solution, and negotiating the hosting contract. The department is playing a critical role in the design and development of the new Corrections Correspondence Service system; leading the design effort and data clean-up and conversion process; converting participants from the old CCS system to NetSuite in preparation for the launch, and actively participating in User Acceptance Testing of the new CCS application.

BOARD COMMITTEES

FINANCE: The board accepted Finance department reports in March, June and July highlighting the following information:

Actual contributions for the six months ended June 30, 2021 were \$4,976,316, which is 51% of the 2021 budget of \$9,725,000 and \$911,513 more than this time last year. The CFO reported that contributions are averaging \$829,386 per month, higher than the budgeted amount of \$810,417 for 2021.

Gross literature sales year to date are \$5,735,705 which is 65% of the 2021 budget of \$8,865,000 and \$837,572 more than last year. Gross literature sales are averaging \$955,950 per month so far this year.

Payroll and benefits year to date are \$4,535,220, which is 49% of the budget amount of \$9,225,438 and \$83,668 less than last year.

Total operating expense year to date is \$7,611,401 which is 53% of the budget amount of \$14,479,506 and \$75,068 more than last year. Total operating expense is more than budget because:

- The NYS unemployment insurance tax rate increased.
- Depreciation expense was budgeted as non-operating expense but is being charged as operating expense in accordance with Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (GAAP).

Surplus for the first six months is \$1,430,178 compared to a budget surplus for the year of \$641,388. The surplus is driven primarily by greater than budgeted literature sales.

As of July 19, operating cash is \$1,620,415, which represents 1.3 months of expenses.

The board approved the following recommendations brought forward by the Finance Committee:

- A request for sharing from the Fellowship about using various “virtual” baskets, especially in terms of our Traditions; and to forward a report to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee for further consideration on updating Conference-approved literature and service pieces with this shared experience.

- Forwarding the 2021 Reforecast Budget 1.0 to the GSB Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, stressing the utmost fiscal prudence.

PUBLISHING: The board accepted Publishing department reports in March, June and July highlighting the following information:

Seven (7) employees of the Publishing department (approximately 50%) have returned as of this June for 1-3 days a week working in-office during this interim hybrid work.

As previously experienced, recent events have arisen that are affecting the timely printing of A.A.W.S. literature. Communications have been delivered to Intergroups and Central Offices and posted on the webstore, notifying our members and other customers that earlier this month we learned that a dramatic rise in Covid-19 outbreaks have befallen at least two of our key printers, with tragic consequences and serious impacts causing potentially ongoing disruptions to the manufacturing and printing of our A.A.W.S. literature and other items.

2020 International Convention souvenir book: "A Visual History of Alcoholics Anonymous: An Archival Journey" has total gross sales of \$177,514.82 as of June 16, 2021.

2021 A.A.W.S. Literature Special Offers and Test Pilots:

1. Five-month Test Pilot on Reduced Shipping Charges, May 17 – October 18, 2021. The pilot was pre-announced to Intergroups and Central Offices April 7 and announced to all customers May 1. As of July 19, "Small Orders" (under \$25) total gross sales are \$35,328. In comparison to the same timeframe in 2020, there is a 31% decrease in number of orders, gross sales increased by \$4,939 and shipping cost decrease by \$4,567. As of July 19, all orders placed by Intergroups and Central Offices, total gross sales are \$106,683. In comparison to the same timeframe in 2020, there is a 45% decrease in number of orders, gross sales decreased by \$117,170, shipping cost decreased by \$279.

2. "A.A. in Your Pocket," July 1 – September 30, 2021. Focusing on Portable editions – buy any pocket editions and get \$1 off each. 304 orders have been placed, 56 of the orders were placed by Intergroups and Central Offices.

3. "Dynamic Duo," August 1 – September 30, 2021 buy the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, hardcover (in English, French or Spanish) and get \$1 off *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* in any language and any format.

Audiobooks: CD sets of the Big Book with new recordings in English, French and Spanish are in the manufacturing process with target in-warehouse dates of mid-September/early-October. Daily Reflections audiobook: Professional audio recordings slated to begin later this summer.

Translations' summary: *Alcoholics Anonymous* is available in 73 languages, with 27 languages pending and 19 new translations in progress, along with 8 revisions/retranslations. *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* is available in 52 languages, with 3 translations pending. *Daily Reflections* is available in 38 languages, with 2 translations pending. *Living Sober* is available in 37 languages, with 5 translations pending. *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* is available in 19 languages, with 2 translations pending. For the period January – June 2021, the total number of translation reviews completed by our independent translation-evaluation services stands at 20 reviews across 9 languages. India and Turkey, in particular, had multiple projects move forward. As of June 30, 2021, items of A.A. literature are available in 110 approved languages.

The Board approved the following recommendations brought forward by the Publishing Committee:

- The Publishing department produce 300 DVD units of the video, “Your General Service Office (G.S.O.), the Grapevine, and the General Service Structure” to be sold at a list price of \$10.
- The Publishing department proceed with a small-run manufacturing of audiobook CD sets of the abridged and unabridged versions of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in English, French and Spanish, as presented, with revisions to units being ordered as appropriate.
- The Publishing department reprint the book, *Experience, Strength, and Hope*, with a soft cover rather than a hard cover, and that the book be priced at \$5.00 per unit.
- The Publishing department proceed with the QSL video production of the pamphlet “Access to A.A.: Members Share on Overcoming Barriers” at the total estimated cost of \$26,295.
- The Publishing department proceed with ASL video production of the pamphlet “Access to A.A.: Members Share on Overcoming Barriers” at an estimated amount not to exceed \$44,000.
- The Publishing department proceed with the production of the newly redesigned, revised and updated “A.A. Service Manual” in the following quantities, at a list price of \$4.00 per unit:
 - English:** 50,000 copies
 - French:** 3,000 copies
 - Spanish:** 8,000 copies
 - Total = 61,000 copies**
- The Publishing department proceed with the printing of the new pamphlet “Experience Has Taught Us: An Introduction to Our Twelve Traditions,” at the following quantities, at a selling price of \$0.36 per unit:
 - English:** 25,000 copies
 - French:** 2,000 copies
 - Spanish:** 10,000 copies
 - Total: 37,000 copies**
- The Publishing department proceed with the printing of the new pamphlet “Hispanic Women in A.A.” at the following quantities, at a selling price of \$0.35 per unit:
 - English:** 15,000 copies
 - Spanish:** 25,000 copies
 - Total: 40,000 copies**

TECHNOLOGY/COMMUNICATION/SERVICES (TCS): The board accepted TCS reports in March, June and July highlighting the following information:

Progress report on Website design – Development of the site page templates is near completion. The CSD content team is entering the approved copy into the page templates. A.A. Staff, Archives and Publishing are reviewing the new pages and working with the CSD Content team to revise and finalize the pages. Finance and Grapevine also reviewed and approved. Plans are being finalized for the transition from the staging site to the production site. The staging environment was moved to the new Acquia platform and the team has been getting familiar with

navigating and using the new Acquia cloud site.

The A.A.W.S. App team, working with Foster Made, has made significant upgrades on Meeting Guide that includes the extension of the Seventh Tradition contribution forms to include PayPal and Cash App. Foster Made has also started work on a subsequent release, which will include: the ability to adjust the radius used when listing meetings and an attendance option to allow the user to filter by in-person, virtual or all.

There are 106 A.A.W.S. videos posted publicly to YouTube (some in English only, others in English, Spanish and French). All ASL videos for the Big Book are public (25 English only). The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions videos (posted private as of February 28, 2020) were posted on 3/25 (27 English only).

LinkedIn – A plan was created to expand LinkedIn with a goal of having at least 1-2 posts per month of content relevant to professionals, including *About A.A.* releases, press releases, G.S.O. employment opportunities, and vacancy announcements (Nominating). The Class A vacancy notice was the first announcement on the LinkedIn page.

The Board approved the following recommendations brought forward by the TCS Committee:

- The Feb. 10, 2021 disclaimer be implemented for leaving aa.org and linking with AA Grapevine and La Viña websites and the Jan. 11, 2021 disclaimer be used for all other links.
- That we proceed with creating and implementing a link from aa.org in the Friends and Family page to the Al-Anon website.
- The March 29, 2021, Website Committee meeting minutes, 2021 First Quarter website report, 2021 analytics loss report and Progress on Website Design report presented on June 25th be forwarded to the trustees' Public Information Committee.
- The June 22nd, 2021, Website Committee meeting minutes, presented on July 29th be forwarded to the trustees' Public Information Committee.
- The Second Quarter website report presented on July 29th be forwarded to the trustees' Public Information Committee.

Internal Audit Committee (IAC): The board approved the following recommendations brought forward by the Internal Audit Committee:

- Modification to the Budget Policy and Procedure Statement for Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc., in the section "Expenditures Not in the Ordinary Course of Business" to state:
 - a. Set the amount for Management to make expenditures without prior notice or approval of the Board of Directors to \$50,000;
 - b. Delete item b in the current policy, and;
 - c. Set the amount of \$50,000 or more for Management to seek and obtain the approval of the Board of Directors prior to making the expenditure.
- The Management RACI be submitted to the A.A.W.S. Board for review.
- The revised Internal Audit Committee Composition, Scope and Procedures be approved.

- The 2021-2022 Finance RACI be approved.

ADDITIONAL ACTIVITIES

The A.A.W.S. Board approved the following recommendations:

- The termination of the AXA Equitable Defined Contribution Plan in favor of the TIAA Plan.
- The termination of the MetLife Defined Contribution Plan in favor of the TIAA Plan.
- The termination of the Mutual of America Defined Contribution Plan in favor of the TIAA Plan.

A.A. World Services, Inc					
GSO (Consolidated)					
Income Statement					
From Jan 2021 to June 2021					
Year to Date vs Budget					
					Actual as %
Financial Row	Actual	Budget	Variance		of Budget
Operating Revenue					
Total - 40000 - Contributions - Members & Groups	\$ 4,976,316	\$ 9,725,000	\$ (4,748,684)		51%
Total - 42000 - International	\$ 8,250	\$ 25,000	\$ (16,750)		33%
Total - 43000 - General Service Conference	\$ 228,565	\$ 204,600	\$ 23,965		112%
Total - 43500 - Contributions - old	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -		N/A
Total - 46000 - Sales	\$ 5,686,088	\$ 8,676,000	\$ (2,989,913)		66%
Total - Operating Revenue	\$ 10,899,219	\$ 18,630,600	\$ (7,731,381)		59%
Total - Cost Of Sales	\$ 2,297,582	\$ 3,036,600	\$ (739,018)		76%
Gross Profit	\$ 8,601,637	\$ 15,594,000	\$ (6,992,363)		55%
Operating Expense					
60100 - Payroll & Benefits : Salaries	\$ 3,587,105	\$ 7,591,581	\$ (4,004,475)		47%
Total - 60300 - Payroll & Benefits : Employee Benefits	\$ 818,125	\$ 1,633,857	\$ (815,732)		50%
Total - 60500 - Payroll & Benefits : Retirement Plan Contributions	\$ 129,990	\$ -	\$ 129,990		0%
SubTotal - 60000 - Payroll & Benefits	\$ 4,535,220	\$ 9,225,438	\$ (4,690,217)		49%
Total - 60400 - Payroll & Benefits : Payroll Taxes	\$ 311,559	\$ 607,326	\$ (295,767)		51%
Total - 61000 - Warehousing - old	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -		N/A
Total - 64000 - Writers Fees	\$ -	\$ 3,000	\$ (3,000)		0%
Total - 70000 - Professional Fees	\$ 1,080,096	\$ 2,434,588	\$ (1,354,492)		44%
Total - 72000 - Printing, Postage, and Supplies Expenses	\$ 230,943	\$ 639,710	\$ (408,767)		36%
Total - 73000 - Data, Automation & Website	\$ 381,373	\$ -	\$ 381,373		N/A
Total - 74000 - Insurance	\$ 27,901	\$ 67,683	\$ (39,782)		41%
Total - 76000 - Facility & Equipment Expenses	\$ 1,026,736	\$ 1,371,561	\$ (344,825)		75%
Total - 78000 - Travel & Meetings Expenses	\$ 17,572	\$ 130,200	\$ (112,628)		13%
Total - 83000 - Bad Debts	\$ -	\$ -			N/A
Total Operating Expense	\$ 7,611,401	\$ 14,479,506	\$ (6,868,106)		53%
Operating Surplus/(Deficit)	\$ 990,236	\$ 1,114,494	\$ (124,258)		89%
% of Revenue	9%	6%			
Other Income and Expenses					
Other Income					
Total - 45000 - Other Revenue	\$ 810,272	\$ -	\$ 810,272		N/A
45600 - Conventions. Meetings & Events	\$ (181,795)	\$ -	\$ (181,795)		N/A
Total - Other Income	\$ 628,477	\$ -	\$ 628,477		N/A
Other Expense					
Total - 92000 - Other Expenses	\$ 188,536	\$ 473,106	\$ (284,570)		40%
Realized Gain/Loss	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -		0%
Unrealized Matching Gain/Loss	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -		0%
Total - Other Expense	\$ 188,536	\$ 473,106	\$ (284,570)		40%
Net Other Income	\$ 439,941	\$ (473,106)	\$ 913,048		-93%
Surplus/(Deficit)	\$ 1,430,178	\$ 641,388	\$ 788,790		223%

A.A. World Services, Inc			
GSO (Consolidated)			
Income Statement			
From Jan 2021 to June 2021			
Current Year vs Prior Year			
	YTD 2021	YTD 2020	Variance
Operating Revenue			
Total - 40000 - Contributions - Members & Groups	\$ 4,976,316	\$ 4,064,803	\$ 911,513
Total - 42000 - International	\$ 8,250	\$ 39,949	\$ (31,699)
Total - 43000 - General Service Conference	\$ 228,565	\$ 250,946	\$ (22,382)
Total - 43500 - Contributions - old	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Total - 46000 - Sales	\$ 5,686,088	\$ 4,861,963	\$ 824,125
Total - Operating Revenue	\$ 10,899,219	\$ 9,217,661	\$ 1,681,558
Total - Cost Of Sales	\$ 2,297,582	\$ 1,102,658	\$ 1,194,924
Gross Profit	\$ 8,601,637	\$ 8,115,003	\$ 486,634
Operating Expense			
60100 - Payroll & Benefits : Salaries	\$ 3,587,105	\$ 3,796,505	\$ (209,399)
Total - 60300 - Payroll & Benefits : Employee Benefits	\$ 818,125	\$ 698,054	\$ 120,071
Total - 60500 - Payroll & Benefits : Retirement Plan Contributions	\$ 129,990	\$ 124,330	\$ 5,660
SubTotal - 60000 - Payroll & Benefits	\$ 4,535,220	\$ 4,618,889	\$ (83,668)
Total - 60400 - Payroll & Benefits : Payroll Taxes	\$ 311,559	\$ 329,461	\$ (17,902)
Total - 61000 - Warehousing - old	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Total - 64000 - Writers Fees	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Total - 70000 - Professional Fees	\$ 1,080,096	\$ 1,080,393	\$ (297)
Total - 72000 - Printing, Postage, and Supplies Expenses	\$ 230,943	\$ 340,164	\$ (109,221)
Total - 73000 - Data, Automation & Website	\$ 381,373	\$ 182,860	\$ 198,512
Total - 74000 - Insurance	\$ 27,901	\$ 26,961	\$ 940
Total - 76000 - Facility & Equipment Expenses	\$ 1,026,736	\$ 776,098	\$ 250,638
Total - 78000 - Travel & Meetings Expenses	\$ 17,572	\$ 181,506	\$ (163,934)
78110 - Transportation	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Total - 83000 - Bad Debts	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Total Operating Expense	\$ 7,611,401	\$ 7,536,332	\$ 75,068
Operating Surplus/(Deficit)	\$ 990,236	\$ 578,670	\$ 411,566
% of Revenue	9%	6%	24%
Other Income and Expenses			
Other Income			
Total - 45000 - Other Revenue	\$ 810,272	\$ (1,386,561)	\$ 2,196,834
45600 - Conventions. Meetings & Events	\$ (181,795)	\$ -	\$ (181,795)
Total - Other Income	\$ 628,477	\$ (1,386,561)	\$ 2,015,039
Other Expense			
Total - 92000 - Other Expenses	\$ 188,536	\$ 57,158	\$ 131,378
Realized Gain/Loss	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Unrealized Matching Gain/Loss	\$ -	\$ (8,385)	\$ 8,385
Total - Other Expense	\$ 188,536	\$ 48,773	\$ 139,763
Net Other Income	\$ 439,941	\$ (1,435,334)	\$ 1,875,276
Surplus/(Deficit)	\$ 1,430,178	\$ (856,664)	\$ 2,286,842

A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
Report to the General Service Board
Monday, August 2, 2021
Josh Eggleston, Chair

The AA Grapevine Board of Directors met virtually seven times since the General Service Conference. A new director's orientation and board planning meeting on June 25th and 26th, an executive session on June 26th, a special meeting on July 22nd and July 26th, to interview publisher candidates. A quarterly board meeting on July 29, an executive session on July 29.

The following committees met virtually: Nominating and Governance met on July 7 and 17; Finance and Budget did not meet this quarter; Strategic Planning met on July 20 and 27; Search Committee met on March 31, April 7, 14, 28, June 2, 16, 30, July 7 and 16.

New Director's Orientation: The Grapevine Board met for a half day of orientation on June 25, 2021. Presentations were made on the following: An overview of AA Grapevine, Inc., including staffing, editorial and the various AAGV, Inc. books and products, vendor partnerships and roles and responsibilities of trustees and non-trustee directors. Tom H., SE Regional Trustee was introduced and shared his story.

Overview -

Over the last 8 months Chris Cavanaugh has been fulfilling the duties of Interim Publisher with diligence and grace as our dear friend and former Publisher, Albin Z., was out on an extended leave. When Albin chose to retire, we began a broad search that saw a record number of submissions, and for the first time included postings and applicants from public job boards at professional publishing trade sites. Among the many great candidates we interviewed, Chris stood out as the right Publisher for right now. His enthusiasm for change balanced by a great love of our principles and traditions are the steady rudder Grapevine and La Viña will need over the next few years as we continue to reflect the Fellowship in all its many voices in every medium available to us.

We are grateful for the service Chris has already provided to support our staff, the Board, and The General Service Conference over these recent months and are excited for the work to come as we continue to grow Grapevine and La Viña into the future.

The Search Committee in this effort was stellar, and we owe a debt of gratitude to it's Chair, Nancy McCarthy, and the immense staff support offered to our committee by Michelle Mirza.

Since the General Service Conference, we hit the ground running. In response to the advisory action requesting, "The A.A. Grapevine Board implement an Instagram account and that a report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña." Our Instagram accounts for both Grapevine and La Viña launched on July 7th and each continues to grow in engagement and content. I look forward to seeing how both develop and reporting that out to the board and to the Conference. Our Grapevine account is closing in on 2,700 followers in the

first 3 weeks, and the La Viña followers jumped 20% following the recent 25th La Viña Anniversary Celebration in Arizona.

We have completed initial demos for a Podcast and the board approved a plan to make a 3-month pilot of 12 episodes, with the possibility of extending for a full year. The General Service Board received an invitation to review these on the Dashboard and we would love to hear your thoughts. Current plans include weekly 30 minute episodes to with a variety of small segments per episode.

We have also been tackling a series of transitions.

Our fulfillment company ESP was acquired by larger company called Omeda. While the initial operational transition had been really smooth, integrating new systems in customer service and financial reporting are proving more challenging which is why our financials only cover the first 5 months of the year. The positive is that up through May Grapevine was tracking ahead of budget and management is working to have numbers through June in the next two to three weeks.

While Omeda's buyout of our fulfillment vendor was out of our control, we were able to keep our printing costs flat due to the proactive efforts of Jonathan Saltos with a loving assist from Kathy Fowler and then Chris Cavanaugh. When costs began to rise with our previous vendor LCS a new vendor was sought and we transitioned to Transcontinental, based in south east Canada. The Seniors in AA issue we all received in the mail this last month was our first with the new printer, and all are thrilled with the process and results.

We are really looking forward to a robust two-day strategic planning meeting in person in September and hope to focus a lot of effort towards overall product improvements and offerings.

Thank you for the opportunity to serve this board and our fellowship.

Board Meeting: During its June 26, 2021 board meeting, the AAGVB was updated on the following: Ongoing communications and planning with book distributor and associates; met with Corrections tablet sales reps to discuss additional intellectual property and artwork needed; met with Corrections Services of Canada to pitch tablet content, books and Carry the Message project;; development of Instagram account; continued work with circulation vendor optimizing product distribution through email efforts to customers; free access to Grapevine and La Viña (May 26- June 10) in honor of Founder's Day; transition to new fulfillment vendor completed; ongoing work with web vendor and new fulfillment house to discuss web user experience; transition to new printer imminent with August issue; ePub sales growing; Digital working group formed with AAGVB members focusing on Podcast, Instagram and working app; GV/LV booth at virtual American Library Association Conference (June 23-30); developed communications to GSC and Fellowship regarding Preamble change; assisting Great Britain AA with their 75th Anniversary celebration; added *Support AA Grapevine* link on GSO contributions page.

Director of Operations reported: Number and type of Preamble communications received from

members; training temporary Executive Assistant; finalized updates to Director's Handbook; reviewing GV.LV collateral materials; filed for Copyright of new Preamble (English and Spanish); ongoing Working Group and Committee work; assisting Acting Publisher with his responsibilities; coordinating NTD resume submissions.

Senior editor reported: Recent Grapevine issues released: April (*Fun in Sobriety*); May (*Our Twelve Steps*); June (*Dating & Relationships*). Magazines in production: July (*Prison Issue*); August (*Sober Seniors*); Sept. (*Young and Sober*); Oct. (*CPC*); Nov. (*Prayer & Meditation*); Dec. (*Remote Communities & Sober Holidays*). Fast tracking COVID stories; Audio Project stories are now being used and uploaded to YouTube; publishing more stories AA News; new *Prayer and Meditation* book completed; *Fun in Sobriety* book stories being selected and cover being developed for Ingram to use on their catalogue; GV Workbook rough draft being edited, updated and revised for 2022 GSC; the new 2022 editorial calendar is completed; GVEAB met in June; working with web coordinator to improve website archives search function; continue to update metadata.

Associate La Viña editor reported: Recent magazines released: July/August (*La Viña celebrates it's 25th Anniversary*). Magazines in production; Sept/Oct. (*Prison Issue*); Nov/Dec. (*Family*); EAB met on June 1; responding to Spanish Preamble queries; managing SMS LV Daily Quote; reviewing LV comp materials; moving editorial process back to print system.

Web Coordinator reported: Set landing pages for *Free on the Inside* and *Mujeres en AA* books, LV SMS and Free Access campaigns; posted Publisher vacancy; collaboration with vendor on Instagram project; deployed Preamble change on website; working with vendor connecting development site to new fulfillment house; replaced default Drupal message on GV and LV websites related to online accounts; maintaining Constant Contact mailing system; added DQ to Sobriety Calculator page.

Production Manager reported: July GV and Jul/Aug LV available; finalizing August issue; 2021 Spring books *Free on the Inside* and *Mujeres En AA* available; 2021 *Prayer and Meditation* book in proofing phase; managing Ingram inventory.

Customer Relations Coordinator reported: In April we received 185 reviews out of which 19 were bad and all customers were responded to. Unfortunately, vendor was unable to provide a Happiness report for May. Investigating what kind of Customer Service reports are available through new fulfillment house. Received training from new fulfillment house; continuing to process CTM gift certificates; processing PayPal and troubleshooting issues with customers, processing books and magazines for special projects.

AA Grapevine, Inc. Financial Report

Grapevine

Circulation

	May 2021 Actual YTD	May 2021 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	May 2020 Actual YTD	Variance 2021 vs. 2020
GV Magazine	59,893	60,550	(657)	65,365	(5,472)
GV Complete	4,927	5,368	(441)	3,469	1,458
GV ePub	3,826	1,630	2,196	-	3,826
Total Circulation	68,645	67,547	1,098	68,834	(188)

Financial Activity

	May 2021 Actual YTD	May 2021 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	May 2020 Actual YTD	Variance 2021 vs. 2020
Net Magazine	580,345	471,958	108,387	532,702	47,643
Net Other Publishing Items	161,563	124,966	36,598	136,062	25,501
Miscellaneous Income	180,000	-	180,000	10,145	169,855
Reserve Fund Interest	12,500	12,500	-	12,500	-
Total Income	934,409	609,424	324,984	691,409	242,999

	May 2021 Actual YTD	May 2021 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	May 2020 Actual YTD	Variance 2021 vs. 2020
Editorial	352,101	362,561	(10,459)	336,928	15,173
Circulation & Business	311,454	328,052	(16,598)	409,186	(97,732)
General & Administrative	1,872	18,537	(16,665)	17,726	(15,853)
Total Cost & Expenses	665,428	709,149	(43,722)	763,840	(98,413)

Net Income	268,981	(99,725)	368,706	(72,431)	341,412
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La Viña

Circulation

	May 2021 Actual YTD	May 2021 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	May 2020 Actual YTD	Variance 2021 vs. 2020
LV Magazine	5,821	5,687	134	8,338	(2,517)
LV Complete	5	-	5	-	5
LV ePub	88	-	88	-	88
Total Circulation	5,913	5,687	226	8,338	(2,425)

Financial Activity

	May 2021 Actual YTD	May 2021 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	May 2020 Actual YTD	Variance 2021 vs. 2020
Net Magazine	272	6,313	(6,041)	29,715	(29,443)
Net Other Publishing Items	4,761	5,088	(327)	19,107	(14,346)
Total Income	5,032	11,400	(6,368)	48,821	(43,789)

	May 2021 Actual YTD	May 2021 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	May 2020 Actual YTD	Variance 2021 vs. 2020
Editorial	101,579	97,208	4,371	101,157	422
Circulation & Business	71,422	59,667	11,755	79,794	(8,373)
General & Administrative	-	600	(600)	-	-
Total Cost & Expenses	173,000	157,475	15,525	180,951	(7,951)
Contribution GSB	101,003	87,295	13,708	-	101,003
Net Income	(66,965)	(58,780)	(8,185)	(132,130)	65,165

Board Committee Activity:

Finance and Budget: The Treasurer reported the committee did not meet since the General Service Conference. Several members of the committee were focused on the AAGV Publisher Search and the NTD Candidates. Other than the May actuals, GV did not have reviewable financials thru June to consider. Ideally, we'll soon resolve our financial reporting process and meet in mid-August.

Nominating and Governance: The chair reported AAGV, Inc. received 37 resumes for the NTD position, which will open after the 2022 GSC. The committee is currently evaluating the candidates and intends to forward a preliminary list to Trustees' Nominating during this GSB weekend.

Strategic Planning: The chair reported the committee reviewed the 2020-2022 Plan and discussed the previous committee's extensive work. It was also recognized that given the pandemic, and changes in leadership, that there was higher than normal burdens placed on the staff to keep publishing the magazine in a timely fashion and to continue multiple book projects along with many other projects. The team was successful in all its activities given the tough working conditions. The team can be recognized for maintaining this success against the backdrop of changes in leadership. With the leadership role not clearly defined or consistent, there were many successes. But some of the projects may not have been as successfully driven or prioritized as they could have been. The committee discussed potential opportunities for the Grapevine and La Viña to pursue over the next few years. Conducting a SWOT analysis provides AAGV, Inc. with a clearer picture of both the internal and external environment (Constraints) in which we are navigating. We will continue to meet in preparation for the upcoming strategic planning session in September.

Ad hoc Search: The chair reported the committee in April 2021 began the process for identifying a Publisher for AAGV, Inc. The committee met weekly. The committee is appreciative for the assistance rendered by the AAWS General Manager search committee, AAWS' Director of Publications and the GSO Archivist.

Editorial Advisory Board: The GVEAB met on June 23. The LVEAB met on July 28. Next meetings will be held in September (GV) and October (LV).

Circulation, Development and Customer Service: The Acting Publisher reported requests continue for additional sources for digital and print subscription development such as new database lists from circulation vendor to meaningfully increase subscriptions; transition of magazine fulfillment successfully completed; new printer shipped August issue on July 15; as of July 23 *Free on the Inside* sold 2,520 copies; *Mujeres en AA* sold 1,123 copies; GV ePub sales consistent; ongoing development of GV and LV websites; online store updates continuing; ongoing email efforts to customers; *Support AA Grapevine* link added to GSO contributions web page; GV.LV participated in American Library Association virtual conference; informational email to Corrections Chairs regarding the Carry the Message project; optimizing product distribution through email efforts to customers; ongoing work with Corrections tablet vendors; met with book distributor marketing expert to discuss ways to grow interest in GV/LV books; customer service is experiencing some difficulties due to the transition to the new fulfillment house. Management is systematically tackling these issues.

Grapevine Editorial Report: The senior editor reported recent Grapevine magazines released: June (*Dating and Relationships*); July (*Prison Issue*); August (*Sober Seniors*). Grapevine magazines currently in production: Sept. (Young and Sober); Oct. (*Cooperation with the Professionals*); Nov. (*Prayer and Meditation*); Dec. (*Remote Communities and Holidays*); Jan. (*Day Counters/Beginners*); new *Prayer and Meditation* book out in Fall 2021; *Fun in Sobriety* book in production (Spring 2022); GV Workbook rough draft being edited, updated and revised for 2022 GSC.

La Viña Editorial Report: The associate La Viña editor reported recent La Viña magazines released: July/Aug (*La Viña celebrates it's 25th Anniversary*). La Viña magazines in production: Sept/Oct (*Prison Issue*); Nov/Dec (*Family*); Jan/Feb (*Acceptance*). SMS continues with email list growing; determined viability of a Spanish-language *Emotional Sobriety* edition from original GV and LV stories.

Web Report: The Web Coordinator reported monthly web traffic in the 2nd quarter averaged 97,933 new visitors; 12,477 returning visitors and 430,983 page views.

In addition to approving the minutes of the March 20, 2021 board meeting, the Board took the following actions at its meeting on June 26, 2021:

- **Accepted** May 2021 Grapevine Treasurer's report.
- **Accepted** May 2021 La Viña Treasurer's report.

In addition to approving the minutes of April 21 and May 1, 2021 the Board took the following action at its meeting on July 29, 2021:

- The board supports the Publisher's plan for a 12-episode Grapevine Podcast pilot.

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Trustees' Archives Committee

Sunday, August 1, 2021

The trustees' Archives Committee met via videoconference on Sunday, August 1, 2021, at 10 a.m.

Present: Al Mooney, chairperson; Molly Anderson, Cathi Clark, Coree Hogan, Nancy McCarthy, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, John Weis and Michelle Mirza, secretary.

Also present: Christopher Cavanaugh, Jimmy Dean, Tom Hoban, Mike Lewis, Stephanie Lyles and Jeff Wine.

Chair's remarks: The chair welcomed all committee members and guests.

Appointment of vice-chair: The chair appointed Nancy McCarthy as vice-chair of the committee.

Report: The report of the January 31, 2021, meeting was approved.

Composition, Scope and Procedure: The committee reviewed and accepted the Composition, Scope and Procedure and made no changes.

Archives report: The archivist's report was read and accepted. The report included updates of projects currently being undertaken by the GSO Archives staff and a list of completed projects.

2021 Conference Committee on Archives committee considerations: The committee reviewed the 2021 Conference Committee on Archives committee considerations. The committee noted the suggestions to add new text in the section "Guidelines for Collecting Oral Histories" in the Archives Workbook on ways to conduct ASL interviews with members who are deaf to offer a greater diversity of sharing; and add sample interview questions relating to "vision for the future" in the subsection "Sample Interview Questions." The committee expressed interest in pursuing the suggestions and requested that the Archivist furnish the committee with more information on how these suggestions might be achieved for discussion at their next meeting in October 2021.

Permission requests: Prior to this meeting and through electronic mail, the committee approved one request in accordance with GSO Archives policies:

A request from Moshe Kasher to receive a copy of an audio recording, for limited use, of his talk at the 2005 International Convention.

The following requests were considered and approved by the committee in accordance with GSO Archives policies:

- A request from Stephen Galleher to receive a copy of an audio recording, for limited use, of the opening and closing sessions of the 2005 A.A. International Convention.
- A request from Taylor Dean to consult archival materials about A.A. and Industry, correspondence with early medical and religious professionals, materials related to the

Oxford Group and other subjects specified in the Research Agreement, that are open for research access.

The committee considered a request from Jay Stinnett to consult archival correspondence held in the Classified Collection on Niacin, Psychic Experience, Parapsychology, and other related subjects specified in the submitted Research Agreement. Following a lengthy discussion, the committee tabled the item and requested that the Archivist provide the committee with all relevant policies regarding access to restricted materials, background history detailing previous requests for these materials, including the rationale behind past decisions made by the committee. The committee will continue discussion on this request at the October 2021 meeting.

New business:

The Archivist requested that the committee consider furnishing copies of correspondence written by Father Ford to a researcher previously approved to consult this material in November 2019. The committee requested that the Archivist provide relevant background for their consideration at the October 2021 meeting and include the researcher's application form and written permission from the estate of Father Ford.

It was suggested that a plan to review and update the GSO Archives Oral Histories Kit be discussed at the committee's next meeting. The Archivist will work with the committee chair to construct a plan and bring back a report at the October 2021 meeting.

The meeting adjourned at 11:52 a.m.

Trustees' General Service Conference Committee

Saturday, July 31, 2021

The trustees' General Service Conference Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, July 31, 2021, at 10 a.m.

Present: Kathi Fowler, chairperson; Beau Bush, Christine Carpenter, Cathi Clark, Jimmy Dean, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, Carolyn Walsh and Steve Smith, secretary.

Also present: Molly Anderson, Brenda Brown, Patrick Claymore, Linda Chezem, Vera Farrell, Francis Gilroy, James Hurst, Racy Joseph, Trish LaNauze, Diana Lewis, Stephanie Lyles, Paz Preciado, Craig Weidner, Bob Wilcox, and Jeff Wine.

Chair's remarks: Kathi Fowler, chairperson, welcomed all in attendance and expressed appreciation for the new committee.

Appointment of vice-chair: The chair appointed Irma Van De Bon-Nicol as vice-chair.

Report: The committee approved the January 30, 2021, meeting report.

Composition, Scope and Procedure: The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that two new Scope items, 9 and 10, be added to the trustees' General Service Conference Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure that read as follows:

9. The 71st G.S.C. advisory action that the Equitable Distribution of Workload process be implemented for the 72nd G.S.C. on a three-year trial basis. The committee will provide a progress report to the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions each year during the three-year trial period.
10. Annually appoint a subcommittee on the G.S.C. Committee Workload, on a three-year trial basis beginning July 2021. The subcommittee is tasked with performing analysis of the proposed agenda item scoring tools and creating an equitable distribution of workload plan for the full trustees' committee to review and approve at the winter Board weekend.

Staff report: The staff report was accepted as written. The committee noted the survey questions outlined for gathering Fellowship sharing on the effectiveness of Conference background translation and expressed support for the plan to involve area delegates in the collection of the sharing. The committee also noted the availability of dynamic survey tools that might be resourced for collating, analyzing and summarizing evaluation responses. Finally, the committee noted the need to explore and review the effectiveness of the delegate committee selection criteria included in the "G.S.C. Guidelines for Drawing

Committee Members” particularly in terms of selection results and possible conflicts of interest.

Review 71st G.S.C. advisory actions pertinent to this committee:

Discuss process for polling the G.S.C between meetings that makes use of virtual meeting technologies: The committee discussed the 71st G.S.C. advisory action for the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee to develop a process for polling the G.S.C. between annual meetings that makes use of virtual meeting technologies, in order to enable real-time discussion and debate, broad participation, and greater efficiency than the current process.

The committee noted that the “Process for Polling Conference Between Meetings” and any revisions to date have been Conference-approved. However, the current request to consider changes to the procedures are requested to be implemented during the current Conference cycle. The committee discussed the importance of the polling to support the complexities of the group conscience decision-making process as much as possible.

The committee agreed to move forward to explore developing and implementing a procedure that makes use of virtual meeting technologies, to improve the polling approach in a way that is compatible with the group conscience process. The committee agreed that background from a G.S.B. ad hoc committee on bylaws would help inform this discussion.

The committee requested that the staff secretary develop a draft plan to include background on the bylaws for committee review at the October 2021 meeting.

Discuss the Equitable Distribution of Workload (EDW) process: The committee discussed the 71st G.S.C. advisory action regarding implementing the EDW process. The committee reviewed the general process outlined for this effort and noted the importance of ongoing evaluation of the process during the first-year implementation.

The chair appointed a subcommittee on the General Service Conference Committee Workload to include Beau B., chair; Cathi C., Jimmy D., and Carolyn W.

The committee noted that the staff secretary will provide the subcommittee chair with regular updates as the implementation of the process unfolds and that the subcommittee will meet as needed to address any issues.

The committee requested the staff secretary work with the chair to create and distribute a communication on behalf of the committee which supports Fellowship-wide notification of the new submission deadline of September 15 for 2022 G.S.C. proposed agenda items.

Review 71st G.S.C. committee considerations pertinent to this committee: The committee noted that there are several committee considerations, once reviewed and discussed by the committee, which may be forwarded to the appointed subcommittee on Conference Improvements for their consideration as part of their scope.

Due to the extensive agenda and limited committee meeting time, the committee agreed to table discussion of the 71st G.S.C. committee considerations pertinent to this committee for an additional committee meeting time to be scheduled soon after this board weekend.

Review 71st G.S.C. simple majority items pertinent to this committee: Due to the extensive agenda and limited committee meeting time, the committee agreed to table discussion of the 71st G.S.C. simple majority items pertinent to this committee for an additional committee meeting time to be scheduled soon after this board weekend.

2022 proposed agenda items report: The committee reviewed the full list of new items that have been proposed for placement on the 72nd General Service Conference agenda.

Consider 72nd G.S.C. proposed agenda item submissions for this committee:

Consider providing "background" material in our three official languages at the same time: The committee discussed a proposed agenda item to "consider providing all its Conference members, the General Service Conference 'background' material in our three official languages at the same time, allowing for all its Conference members equal opportunity and time to be prepared, and therefore well informed."

The committee noted that process improvements have been taken, and continue to be considered, for the Conference "background" material to be made available in all three Conference languages as expediently as possible. The committee also noted that a GSO survey is scheduled to be undertaken to gather sharing from the Fellowship on this topic which will inform later discussions.

The committee agreed to continue the discussion at the October 2021 meeting.

Consider request for all Conference member communications and information to be provided in all three language year round: The committee discussed a proposed agenda item to "consider that when communicating with all its Conference members, before and after, as well as throughout the year, all information, shared documents, presentations and other forms of written communications (emails, for example) be sent to Conference members in our three official languages, eliminating the need for Conference members to request a French or Spanish translation for any of the above material" and took no action.

The committee noted that there used to be a lag time between the availability of assignment material in English compared to in Spanish and French. However, starting in 2021, the translations of these Conference "assignment" materials are being distributed simultaneously with a focus on equity for all Conference members.

GSO management implemented the new procedure with a focus on equity for all Conference members.

Consider alternating G.S.C. between a virtual and face-to-face format: The committee discussed a proposed agenda item to “consider the request to alternate the G.S.C. between virtual and face-to-face formats.” The chair appointed a subcommittee on Conference Improvements to include Irma V., chair; Christine C. and Carolyn W.

The committee requested that the staff secretary forward this proposed agenda item for consideration by the subcommittee as part of its scope. The committee requested that the subcommittee provide a progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Request from observers to attend the 2022 G.S.C.: The committee discussed two requests for representatives from general service structures outside of the U.S./Canada to attend the 2022 G.S.C. as observers.

The committee recommended the following to the General Service Board:

That the request for two persons from A.A. in Brazil, Maria do Carmo Angelin Inojosa Zanré and Ana Elisa Limeira, Board of Trustees “Class B,” be approved to attend the 2022 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as observers.

That the request for one person from A.A. in Argentina, a trustee, be approved to attend the 2022 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as observer.

Consider recommitted recommendation inviting Panel 70 delegates to attend a future in-person G.S.C.: The committee discussed the recommitted recommendation to invite Panel 70 delegates to attend a future in-person G.S.C. The committee noted the unusual circumstances resulting from the pandemic so that delegates participated in virtual versus in-person Conferences. It was discussed that the role and experience of participating as a non-voting attendee may not accomplish the delegate’s desired outcome. This action could cause inequity, if delegates pay their own way, as some delegates might not be able to pay these suggested out-of-pocket travel expenses.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board:

To further review the proposal: To extend an open invitation to all Panel 70 delegates to attend a future face-to-face General Service Conference as a non-voting observer with each delegate to cover their own expense for the trip.

NOTE: The General Service Board voted not to extend an open invitation to Panel 70 delegates to attend a future face-to-face G.S.C. at their own expense

Review 71st G.S.C. Evaluations, Post-Conference Sharing Session notes and the draft 2022 Conference Week Schedule: The committee requested that the appointed subcommittee on Conference Improvements review the 71st G.S.C. Evaluations, the Post-Conference Sharing Session notes, and the draft 2022 Conference Week Schedule

as part of their scope. The committee understands there is a significant amount of evaluation information to review and lessons to be learned that can enrich the General Service Conference experience and its schedule for next year. The subcommittee can use this information as they complete their work.

The committee looks forward to a progress report from the subcommittee at the October 2021 meeting.

The committee adjourned at 12:36 p.m.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

That two new Scope items, 9 and 10, be added to the trustees' General Service Conference Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure that read as follows:

9. The 71st G.S.C. advisory action that the Equitable Distribution of Workload process be implemented for the 72nd G.S.C. on a three-year trial basis. The committee will provide a progress report to the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions each year during the three-year trial period.
10. Annually appointing a subcommittee on the G.S.C. Committee Workload, on a three-year trial basis beginning July 2021. The subcommittee is tasked with performing analysis of the proposed agenda item scoring tools and creating an equitable distribution of workload plan for the full trustees' committee to review and approve at the winter Board weekend.

That the request for two persons from A.A. in Brazil, Maria do Carmo Angelin Inojosa Zanré and Ana Elisa Limeira, Board of Trustees "Class B," be approved to attend the 2022 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as observers.

That the request for one person from A.A. in Argentina, a trustee, be approved to attend the 2022 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as an observer.

To further review the proposal: To extend an open invitation to all Panel 70 delegates to attend a future face-to-face General Service Conference as a non-voting observer with each delegate to cover their own expense for the trip.

NOTE: The General Service Board voted not to extend an open invitation to Panel 70 delegates to attend a future face-to-face G.S.C. at their own expense.

**Trustees' Cooperation with the Professional
Community/ Treatment and Accessibilities Committee**
Sunday, August 1, 2021

The trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee met by videoconference on Sunday, August 1, 2021, at 1 p.m.

Present: Nancy McCarthy, chair, Molly Anderson, Cathi Clark, Vera Farrell, Cindy French, Tom Hoban, Al J. Mooney and co-secretaries, Amy C. Bailey, and Brenda Brown

Also present: Christine Carpenter, Patrick Claymore, Irene Donoso, Julie Gonzalez, Jan Lembke, Paz Preciado, Atallah Sophas, Julisa Soriano, Jeff Wine, Sharon Vasquez, Mike Wilson (technical support), Jeff Wine

Part I

Chair's remarks: The chair welcomed all committee members and visitors in attendance. Nancy announced that appointed committee member George W, will no longer serve on the C.P.C committee. The committee noted that the appointed committee member decided to step down from this service position and expressed their gratitude for his contributions regarding the military audio interviews.

Appointment of vice-chairperson: The chair appointed Tom Hoban as vice-chair of the committee.

Approval of meeting report: The committee approved the January 31, 2021, meeting report.

Review of Composition, Scope, and Procedure: The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and made no changes.

Part II – Cooperation with the Professional Community

Staff report: The committee accepted the staff report as presented.

2021 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community advisory actions and committee considerations: The committee reviewed the list of 2021 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community advisory actions and committee considerations pertaining to the committee.

Pamphlet for mental health professionals: The committee discussed the 2021 C.P.C. advisory action, "That the trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee develop a pamphlet directed to mental health professionals..." The committee discussed the request to create a pamphlet for mental health professionals and suggested that the first action is to explore

assembling a focus group of past/present Class A's trustees' and other mental health professionals that are member of the fellowship for the purpose of asking what their needs are when addressing the suffering alcoholic. The committee looks forward from the staff secretary a progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous: The committee discussed the 2021 C.P.C advisory action "that the updated draft pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" be approved with minor editorial changes and retitled "Faith Leader Ask About Alcoholic Anonymous." The staff secretary will send a memorandum to G.S.O. Publishing department requesting implementation.

C.P.C. Workbook: The committee reviewed the 2021 C.P.C. consideration to review the C.P.C. workbook and requested that the staff secretary survey the local C.P.C. committees for shared experience on creative ways to carry the A.A. message to professionals, including but not limited to, during the Covid-19 pandemic. The committee also asked the staff secretary to create service material relating to "attraction vs promotion" when conducting C.P.C. committee work.

LinkedIn progress report: The committee discussed the 2021 C.P.C. advisory action "the goals expressed in the 2018 advisory action establishing a dynamic A.A.W.S. LinkedIn page be implemented by G.S.O. to provide current and relevant content about A.A. to professionals in accordance with A.A. principles and Traditions..." The committee reviewed and discussed the LinkedIn progress report and requested the staff secretary to research and report findings to the committee on the following items:

- How Class A trustees could cultivate awareness with professionals about the LinkedIn profile.
- Guideline and tutorial for Class A's on how to create a LinkedIn profile.
- The use of "hashtags" in LinkedIn and requested samples of how they can be used on our LinkedIn page.
- The committee discussed that currently when Class A's vacancies are closed the posting are removed. The committee requested development of language for ways to keep information about Class A's service positions on LinkedIn.

Memo to ad hoc working group on "Does Alcoholics Anonymous Work?": The committee reviewed the memo and requested that the staff secretary send the link to the video "Does Alcoholics Anonymous Work?" to committee members, and that committee members be prepared for a discussion at the October 2021 meeting on how it can be shared (in keeping the A.A. Traditions).

"A.A. in Your Community": The committee reviewed a progress report on "A.A. in Your Community" submitted by G.S.O.'s executive editor that provided clarification about

the target audience for the pamphlet. The committee looks forward to a draft pamphlet or progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Discuss using Health Care Media distribution: The committee discussed using Health Care Media distribution and requested the staff secretary to explore and report on options for distribution at the October 2021 meeting.

C.P.C. exhibits: The committee recognized that due to Covid-19, most face-to-face exhibits have been canceled for the year 2020 and most of 2021. The staff secretary reported facilitating Alcoholics Anonymous attendance along with participation by the local C.P.C. committee at the American Probation and Parole Association Conference, August 23-25, 2021. The staff secretary will review scheduling of the remaining exhibits for September through December 2021 for participation and develop a progress report for the October 2021 meeting detailing the C.P.C. exhibit opportunities in 2022.

Part III – Treatment

Staff report: The committee approved the staff report as presented.

2021 Conference advisory actions and committee considerations: The committee reviewed advisory actions and committee considerations pertinent to the committee from the Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook: The committee reviewed suggestions for the contents of the Treatment Committee Kit and agreed to discuss at their October 2021 meeting.

"Bridging the Gap" pamphlet: The committee reviewed a progress report from the executive editor on the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap" and looks forward to a draft or progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Bridging the Gap Service Materials: The committee reviewed a progress report from the executive editor on the Bridging the Gap service materials and looks forward to receiving drafts or a progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Part IV - Accessibilities

Staff report: The staff report was accepted as written.

Review related 71st G.S.C. advisory actions and considerations: The committee reviewed the related advisory action and committee considerations.

Review progress report on pamphlet "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic: The committee chair assigned committee members to review the compiled stories and identify the top three

and four submissions for the pamphlet "A.A. for the Older Alcohol." The committee asked the secretary to distribute the matrix and background. The committee agreed to discuss their selections at their October 2021 meeting.

Armed Forces audio interviews subcommittee: The chair appointed a subcommittee, Tom Hoban chair, Molly Anderson, and Cindy French on creating audio interviews of A.A. members who are in the Armed Forces. The committee agreed to the following scope for the subcommittee:

- Identify a consultant to serve on the committee with a target date.
- Develop a questionnaire for audio-military interviews.
- Request to a broad cross-section of A.A. members.

In order to support this effort, the committee agreed to identify consultants from Canada and the U.S. with relevant military experience, who can continue the work on the project. The committee consulted with the chair of Nominating Committee, regarding procedure (#13 Procedures for selecting consultants for General Service Board Committees) to be done prior meeting in September 2021.

Accessibilities Kit and Workbook: The committee reviewed suggestions for the contents of the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook.

Remote Communities guidelines: The committee reviewed a progress report from the executive editor on A.A. Guidelines on Remote Communities and looks forward to a draft or progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Digital accessibilities and a Remote Community Workbook: The committee reviewed a memo from A.A.W.S. on development of a digital service materials including service committee workbooks.

Subcommittee on A.A. Guidelines on Accessibilities: The chair appointed a subcommittee, Cathi Clark chair, Al Mooney, and Vera Farrell to update the A.A. Guideline on Accessibility. The committee noted the need to update the Accessibilities Checklist, particularly the absence of shared experience about reducing barriers to participation in A.A. by members who have intellectual and learning difficulties. The committee is looking forward to a progress report at their October 2021 meeting.

Replacing the term "special needs" in A.A. literature: The committee discussed ongoing efforts to replace the term "special needs" in A.A. literature. The staff secretary noted a grid with possible optional language to the term "Special Needs" and will distribute to the committee for review. The committee agreed to discuss at their October 2021 meeting.

The meeting adjourned at 3:30pm.

Trustees' Corrections Committee

Saturday, July 31, 2021

The trustees' Corrections Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, July 31, 2021, at 10:00 a.m. (The trustees' Corrections Committee also met on July 12 and 22, 2021, 7 p.m. – 9 p.m., to begin discussion on the list of suggested changes to the Corrections Kit and Workbook submitted by the 2021 Conference Committee on Corrections.)

Present: Mike Lewis, chairperson; Tom Hoban, Coree Hogan, Sister Judith Ann Karam, Jan Lembke, Marita Rhinehart, John Weis, and Sandra Wilson (interim secretary).

Also present: Brenda Brown, Chris Cavanaugh, Nancy McCarthy, Ana Mejia-Andrade, Al Mooney, Kevin Prior, David Rosen, Attallah Sophas, Mike Wilson (technical support).

Chairperson's remarks: The chairperson warmly welcomed all committee members and guests.

Appointment of vice-chair: The chairperson appointed Jan Lembke as vice-chair of the committee.

Composition, Scope and Procedure: The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and made no changes.

Report: The committee approved the January 31, 2021, meeting report.

Staff report: The committee accepted the staff report as presented. A summary indicates that the collaboration with AA Grapevine to offer free Grapevine and La Viña subscriptions to persons in custody has been implemented; and that the September 2021 launch of the new Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) database will greatly improve the process of matching persons in custody with outside members.

Report of the 2021 Conference Committee on Corrections: The committee reviewed and discussed the advisory action and committee considerations from the 2021 Conference Committee on Corrections.

Advisory Action

- Revision to A.A.W.S. literature directed to members behind the walls to replace the terms "inmate" and "offender" with "person in custody." The committee discussed and requested that the advisory action be forwarded to Publishing and that an update report be brought back to the October 2021 meeting.

Committee Considerations

- Review corrections materials for corrections professionals and explore the need for developing different language to refer to "persons in custody." The committee requested that the staff secretary gather information as to the exact items of literature/service material intended or used by corrections professionals and bring back the findings to the October 2021 meeting.

- Development of service material that will explain digital distribution to local corrections committees. The committee discussed and agreed that since we are in the early stages of digital distribution and that the shared experience would vary widely, it was premature at this time to develop service material that would comprehensively address and provide step-by-step guidance on using digital materials in local correction settings; the committee agreed to table this matter until more information is available

G.S.O.'s publishing director provided the committee with a verbal update on the viable options to make A.A. literature in digital formats available for alcoholics in correctional facilities. In collaboration with AA Grapevine, which is leading the way to pilot the endeavors, the project is moving along apace with contracts in place with several major vendors that provide tablets into correctional facilities. It was reported that much progress has been experienced within Canada as well.

Grapevine's acting publisher also reported great success with one such vendor which has been very active in utilizing Grapevine and La Viña materials in facilities with the ability to also track usage. Grapevine's acting publisher noted concern expressed by some area correction chairs that the digital distribution of literature in correctional facilities will cannibalize their involvement in providing literature to the facilities.

- Exploration of thread-based forums and new communication models that would allow members and committees carrying the message behind the walls to access and provide shared experience. The committee discussed and agreed that while timely and effective, thread-based communication models (i.e., message boards) are best initiated and managed by the Fellowship at the local level.

The committee noted the sample digital newsletter provided in the background and indicated that this format may be valuable for newsletters like *Sharing From Behind the Walls*.

- Corrections Kit and Workbook. The committee expressed great appreciation for the extensive work by the National Corrections Committee in reviewing the Corrections Kit and Workbook. The trustees' Committee on Corrections met twice prior to today's meeting to review and discuss the list of suggested changes and plan to schedule a date in September 2021 to complete the review.

The committee also inquired as to the existing stock of Corrections Workbooks and Kits (in the interest that the current inventory would be retired after updates are completed) and were advised that as of July 12, 2021, 266 Kits are available on hand and should be depleted in seven months – at the current rate of usage.

Review suggested ideas for retitling the book A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate and pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic": The committee discussed several suggested titles for the book *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* submitted by the Publishing department and agreed the following three titles were the most desirable:

- A.A. in Prison: A message of hope
- A.A. Behind the Walls: member to member
- A.A. Behind the Walls: one alcoholic to another

The committee also discussed the suggestions for retitling the pamphlet “Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic,” and agreed to discuss further at the October 2021 meeting.

Consider suggested text for addition to pre-release service material for A.A. members on the inside: The committee reviewed the submitted quote suggested for addition to pre-release service material for A.A. members on the inside. The committee agreed that a different quote reflecting inclusivity (i.e., no religious leaning) would be more welcoming and have a broader appeal. The committee requested that the secretary gather the quotes previously submitted and add them to the background for the October 2021 meeting for the committee’s review.

Corrections Correspondence Service in Canada: A request for sharing on service in correctional facilities in Canada was distributed to trusted servants doing corrections work in Canada. Currently, no responses have been received.

Jan L. informed the committee that she and Ruth L. (a member who is very involved in Corrections service in Canada) are meeting with the National Corrections Service in Ottawa; Jan will report back results of the meeting to the committee in October 2021.

Corrections Correspondence Service Database: A demo of the new Corrections Correspondence Service database was provided to the committee – co-presented by Lorna Graham, GSO’s technical services director, and Brenda B., GSO staff on the Corrections assignment. Scheduled to launch in September 2021, the new, state of the art digital application will enable matching of persons in custody to members on the outside with speed and efficacy. Some of the new features include matching based on miles rather than region – exponentially increasing matching possibilities; and expansion of the program to effortlessly match members in Canada.

The committee expressed appreciation for the demonstration and looks forward to the launch in September.

The meeting adjourned at 11:57 a.m.

Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee

Sunday, August 1, 2021

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee met via videoconference on Sunday, August 1, 2021, at 1:00 p.m.

Present: Kevin Prior, chair; Jimmy Dean, Josh Eggleston, Kathi Fowler, Francis Gilroy, Deborah Koltai, Mike Lewis, Carolyn Walsh, Linda Chezem, Bob Wilcox and Zenaida Medina, secretary.

Also present: Terry Bedient, Chris Cavanaugh, James Hurst, Judith Ann Karam, Paul Konigstein, Trish LaNauze, Diana Lewis, Stephanie Lyles, Paz Preciado, Marita Rhinehart, Steven SanInocencio, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, Craig Weidner, John Weis, and Maria Morales-Lamm (technical support).

Chairperson's remarks: Kevin Prior opened the meeting with a moment of silence and the Serenity Prayer. After roll call Kevin welcomed the committee and shared that he's honored to chair this meeting. He also shared a message from Sharon S., Conference Finance Committee chair, who sends her good wishes to the committee and looks forward to being with us in January 2022.

Composition, Scope and Procedure: The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and made no changes. Kevin Prior reported that in the next year he will engage the Committee in an update to the language related to the Reserve Fund Investment Advisory subcommittee based on committee review and feedback.

Report: The report of the January 31, 2021, meeting was approved.

Appointment of vice-chair: The chair appointed Mike Lewis as vice-chair of the committee.

GSO financial results: The committee reviewed the GSO unaudited financial results for June 30, 2021. Gross literature sales for the first six months of 2021 were \$5,735,705 which is 65% of the 2021 budget of \$8,865,000 and \$837,572 more than last year. June gross sales were \$981,496, just missing becoming the second month over \$1 million since February 2020 (not counting February 2021, which was skewed by recognizing the pre-order revenue for the souvenir book).

Contributions for the first six months of the year were \$4,976,316, which is 51% of the 2021 budget of \$9,725,000 and \$911,513 more than this time last year. The committee expressed its gratitude to the Fellowship for the continuing Seventh Tradition support.

Total revenue for the first six months of the year was \$10,899,219 which is \$1,653,981 more than budgeted. The reforecast for the 2021 budget projects an increase in revenues of approximately 10%.

Total operating expenses for the period ending June 30, 2021, were \$7,611,401 which is 53% of the budget amount of \$14,479,506 and \$47,491 more than last year. Payroll and

benefits year to date are \$4,535,220, which is 49% of the budget amount of \$9,225,438 and \$83,668 less than last year. Professional fees are \$1,080,096 year to date which is 44% of the budgeted amount and \$297 less than last year. Total operating expenses are more than budget because the NYS unemployment insurance tax rate increased. Also, depreciation expense was budgeted as a non-operating expense but is being charged as operating expense in accordance with Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (GAAP).

The combination of the above revenues and expenses resulted in GSO reporting a preliminary surplus of \$1,430,178. This compares to a budgeted surplus of \$641,388.

The GSO financial report was accepted by the committee.

2021 budget reforecast: For the year 2021, there is a reforecast of the budget. This budget includes new revenue estimates and decreases in expenses. Total operating revenue is projected to be \$17,084,572, an increase of \$1,490,572 which is 10% from the original budget. Total operating expense is projected to be \$16,416,862, an increase of \$764,048 which is 5% of the original budget. The committee discussed in detail the reductions and additions proposed in the reforecasted budget. They also discussed being prudent with expenses and sending a message to the Fellowship about the importance in replenishing the Reserve Fund.

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the re-forecasted budget, which reflects gross sales of \$11,400,000, contributions revenue of \$10,000,000 and a bottom-line surplus of \$667,710.

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee recommended that the General Service Board approve an immediate transfer of \$250,000 to the Reserve Fund.

Reserve Fund: On June 30, 2021, the Reserve Fund balance was \$12,537,739. No additions or withdrawals have been made during this year. The current balance covers 8.41 months of expenses calculated based on the original expense budget for 2021.

The committee requested research from Archives regarding the history of the Reserve Fund Investment Advisory subcommittee mentioned in the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the TFC. The committee secretary will send a memo to Archives.

Grapevine financial results: The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee received a memo from Chris Cavanaugh, acting publisher, regarding the new engagement with their subscription fulfillment center. Due to the transition from one fulfillment center to the other they are not currently able to produce accurate statements for the period ending June 30, 2021. They will send complete June 2021 financials to the Board sometime in August.

Francis Gilroy presented the unaudited year end results for the period ending May 31, 2021. Average paid circulation of the Grapevine magazine was 68,645. This compared with a budget of 67,547 and 2020 actual of 68,834.

Total income for the first five months of the year was \$934,409 which is \$324,984 more than budgeted and \$242,999 more than the \$691,409 achieved in 2020.

Total costs and expenses of the magazine for the first five months were \$665,428, which were \$43,722 lower than budgeted and \$98,413 less than the \$763,840 in 2020.

After adding interest earned, there was a net income for the period ending May 31, 2021, of \$268,981 compared to a budgeted net loss of \$99,725.

The Grapevine financial report was accepted by the committee.

La Viña results: For the unaudited results for May 31, 2021, average paid subscriptions for La Viña were 5,913 compared to 5,687 budgeted and 8,338 in May 2020. Income from magazine sales was \$5,032 compared with a budget of \$11,400. After deducting the costs and expenses of \$173,000, a shortfall between revenue and expenses of \$167,968 resulted for this service activity. This compares with a budgeted shortfall of \$146,075 and a shortfall of \$132,130 for 2020. The shortfall for the La Viña service activity is funded by a transfer from the General Fund of the G.S.B.

The La Viña financial report was accepted by the committee.

Auditor Selection Policy review – The committee reviewed the proposed policies for the selection of the independent auditor in the January 2021 TFC meeting and requested some changes. The amended policy has been reviewed and received by the TFC committee.

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the Auditor Selection Policy with a clarification that the current auditors are also eligible to be part of the RFP process.

Review Conference Committee on Finance actions/considerations: The committee reviewed the committee considerations that resulted from discussions of the 2021 General Service Conference Committee on Finance and accepted the report.

The committee agreed to forward to Publishing the consideration regarding updating various materials with the pie chart changes that were accepted in the advisory action of the committee.

A.A.W.S. report on self-support: Deborah Koltai updated the committee on the activities of the self-support subcommittee. The committee met on June 7, 2021, and discussed the committee considerations from the 2021 Conference Committee on Finance regarding adding language to service material on how to support the AA Grapevine. They forwarded a memo to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee with the consideration.

The committee also reviewed and discussed the proposed agenda item, "Request sharing from the Fellowship about using various 'virtual' baskets, especially in terms of our Traditions, to ensure our Conference-approved literature and service pieces reflect our Fellowship's experiences and principles." The A.A.W.S. Finance Committee agreed that the A.A.W.S. self-support subcommittee is going to take the lead on gathering the shared experience on virtual baskets and looks forward to receiving an update from the subcommittee at a future meeting.

The self-support subcommittee also met on July 8, 2021. During this meeting they reviewed the contributions envelope design of the STELLAR committee. The committee offered function, style and editorial suggestions on the contribution and birthday envelopes and asked the staff secretary to forward a memo with this sharing to the STELLAR committee.

They also discussed SMF-176, Services Provided by the G.S.O./A.A.W.S., draft update. The committee reviewed and discussed a final draft of an updated version that includes new departments and services provided from GSO. The committee also discussed the SMF-203 "Seventh Tradition Fact Sheet," that summarizes services that GSO provides. The committee noted the brevity of SMF-203 and suggested to update this service material, and to add a link to contribution acknowledgements from A.A. members across the U.S. and Canada

The committee agreed to forward to GSO Publishing the committee consideration of the Conference Committee on Finance to update, "The A.A. Group Treasurer" and the A.A. Guidelines on Finance to include how to financially support the AA Grapevine. This includes the suggestions in the memo provided by the self-support subcommittee.

Retirement Committee update – The CFO reported that the Retirement Committee met on Thursday, February 23, 2021, at approximately 3:00 p.m. Tom Sutton, BPAS investment adviser, reviewed the portfolio performance for the twelve months ended December 31, 2020. The ending value for the year was \$34,618,354. Capital appreciation of \$3,632,477 and investment income of \$666,186 were offset by net withdrawals of \$9,312,074. The return on investment for the year was 12.76% compared to the target index return of 12.20%. Year to date management, actuarial, and trustee fees total \$141,636, which is about 0.41% of the portfolio market value.

The committee also heard a report from Amy Kemp, BPAS actuary, on the actuarial position of obligations and assets of the Defined Benefit Pension Plan. Under the accounting standard for calculating the pension benefit obligation, plan assets as of December 31, 2020, are \$34,618,354 and liabilities are \$37,736,654. The discount rate used to determine the benefit obligation at the end of 2020 is 2.5%. Assets and liabilities both declined during 2020 due to the early retirement window and lump sum elections. The Benefits paid for the year were \$9,323,324 and of this amount approximately \$7.8M was paid in the form of a lump sum. No liabilities exist in the plan for those who selected the lump sum option, and the overall assets were reduced. The Net Periodic Pension cost is the calculation of the cost of the plan that moves through the income statement each year. In 2019 a routine year for the Plan cost was \$821,943 but in 2020 the Plan cost was \$5,136,323. This is due to the early retirement window. Including three special accounting calculations related to the early retirement window, the change in unrestricted net assets was a decrease of \$2,943,811.

Paul explained that in 2018 the committee requested that BPAS give estimates on Pension Annuitization. Due to the pandemic and the Voluntary Retirement Incentive Program the analysis on annuitizing the pension needed to be updated. Amy Kemp presented estimates of the impact of offering lump sum distributions and purchasing annuities for terminated vested and retired participants of the Defined Benefit Plan. This was done so that the committee can discuss the merits of the proposal and decide whether to go through with the annuitization of the remaining participants in the Defined Benefit Plan.

After Amy's presentation, the committee had a robust discussion and asked questions on the different scenarios. The committee didn't feel comfortable making any recommendations regarding annuitizing the Pension Plan and requested an additional meeting for further discussion. The committee also acknowledged that a few members of the committee are rotating after Conference and that new members would be part of the Retirement Committee.

The meeting adjourned at 3:05 p.m.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the re-forecasted budget, which reflects gross sales of \$11,400,000, contributions revenue of \$10,000,000 and a bottom-line surplus of \$667,710.

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee recommended that the General Service Board approve an immediate transfer of \$250,000 to the Reserve Fund.

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the Auditor Selection Policy with a clarification that the current auditors are also eligible to be part of the RFP process.

Trustees' International Committee

Sunday, August 1, 2021

The trustees' International Committee met via videoconference on Sunday, August 1, 2021 at 10 a.m.

Present: Trish LaNauze, chair; Christine Carpenter, Linda Chezem, Ino Fernandez, Kathi Fowler, Sister Judith Ann Karam, Paz Preciado, Kevin Prior, Marita Rhinehart, Bob Wilcox and Racy Joseph, secretary.

Also present: Clement Cann, Christopher Cavanaugh, Patrick Claymore, Vera Farrell, Francis Gilroy, Julie Gonzalez, James Hurst, Jan Lembke, Al Mooney, David Rosen, Carolyn Walsh, Craig Weidner, Sandra Wilson and consultants, Daniel Brown, Mary Cumings.

Chair's remarks: The chair welcomed all committee members and guests and thanked Mary Cumings for her stellar years of service to GSO and most recently, staffing the International desk.

Appointment of vice-chair: The chair appointed Marita Rhinehart as vice-chair of the committee.

Report: The committee approved the report of January 31, 2021 meeting.

Review Composition, Scope and Procedure: The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and made the following editorial updates: Under the committee's Composition paragraph #1 the word "overseas" will be changed to "international," Scope #1 and #9 the word "overseas" will be changed to "outside the U.S. and Canada."

The committee recommended that Procedure #5 of the Composition, Scope and Procedure which currently reads:

5. The committee reviews suggestions regarding international travel made by the Trip Consultation Team, which includes as its members: the chair of the General Service Board, both trustees-at-large, U.S. and Canada, general manager of GSO and the staff member on the International assignment.

be revised to reflect the change made by the committee in February 2015 as follows:

5. The committee reviews suggestions regarding international travel made by the Trip Consultation Team, which includes as its members: the chair of the General Service Board, both trustees-at-large, U.S. and Canada, another trustee appointed by the General Service Board chair, general manager of GSO and the staff member on the International assignment.

Staff report: The staff report was accepted as presented.

International trip reports: The committee received reports on the following virtual international events, followed by questions and discussion:

February 5-6, 2021	XXIII A.A. Gathering of the Southern Area Chile (virtual) Mary Cumings, Irene Donoso, James Hurst, Sandra Wilson	Trish LaNauze Newton Pritchett
February 13, 2021	AOSM Policy/Admissions/Finance Committee Meeting (virtual)	Trish LaNauze Mary Cumings
February 27, 2021	30th Anniversary of A.A. in Romania Bucharest, Romania (virtual)	Trish LaNauze Dr. Al Mooney
March 7 & 8, 2021	Argentina IV Meeting of A.A. Women (virtual)	Trish LaNauze Mary Cumings
March 19, 2021	45th Anniversary of A.A. Japan (virtual)	Trish LaNauze Michele Grinberg
April 6, 2021	Brazil Trustees' Literature Committee Meeting (virtual)	David Rosen Rosa Rodriguez Brittinae Brasfield
April 10, 2021	82nd Big Book Anniversary Peru (virtual)	David Rosen
Monthly 2021	REDELA Sharing Sessions (virtual)	Newton Pritchett Trish LaNauze Marita Rhinehart

Tentative international trips: The committee reviewed a list of international meetings scheduled for 2021:

TBD	Argentina Online Communication meeting (virtual) Julie Gonzalez, Trish LaNauze, David Rosen	Clement Cann Josh Eggleston
July 30-Aug.7, 2021	XXXII Peruvian GSC	Trish LaNauze Marita Rhinehart Racy Joseph
October 3-7, 2021	REDELA Meeting of the Americas Antigua, Guatemala (face-to-face) <i>Exploring hybrid</i>	TBD

Sept. 24-26, 2021	Sub Saharan Africa Service Meeting Johannesburg, South Africa (virtual)	TBD
October 22-24, 2021	European Service Meeting York, England (<i>exploring hybrid</i>)	TBD

North/South Connections: The committee reviewed reports and evaluation questionnaire summaries for Phase I of the North/South Connections virtual pan-continental two-way shared experience which took place on May 15, 2021. The committee noted that Phase II of North/South Connections is being led by the Regional Forums assignment. Just as Argentina invited us into their planning process, we are looking forward to having Argentina (and Chile) join GSO as planning partners for a North/South Special Forum.

REDELA zonal meeting (Meeting of the Americas) and self-support: The committee discussed the REDELA and reviewed a description of the REDELA Fund.

To join with other countries in more equitably ensuring that all countries that wish to participate, may have that opportunity, the committee recommended that the General Service Board U.S./Canada contribute \$5,000 (US) to the REDELA Fund.

International A.A. Data Map: The committee discussed the International Data Map project and noted there have been no updates to the data since 2018, pending implementation improvements of NetSuite. The Technology Services department, Member and Customer Services department, Publishing department and International desk are involved in the operations of this interactive map.

The chair asked that a subcommittee be formed with Marita Rhinehart, chair, Ino Fernandez and Paz Preciado to review the original intent and goals of the map project and reexamine the map's purpose, values, and target audience as both an internal and potentially external tool to carry the A.A. message.

Licensing and translations activity report: The committee reviewed and accepted a report regarding A.A. literature licensing and translations activity.

Listing of online groups: The committee discussed advisory actions 32 and 33 of the 71st General Service Conference regarding the recognition, participation, and listing of online groups in the U.S./Canada Service Structure.

The committee recommended that advisory actions 32 and 33 of the 71st General Service Conference (listed below) be forwarded to the General Service Board and that a committee(s) be formed to discuss these actions and that both domestic (U.S./Canada) and International impact be considered in all discussions and implementation.

32. The U.S./Canada General Service Structure recognize online groups and encourage their participation, listing those groups who ask to be listed within the group's preferred district and area, with the default option being the location of the group's primary contact. This supersedes the 1997 Advisory Action that designated online groups as "International Correspondence Meetings."
33. The General Service Board form a committee to explore future possibilities for the participation of online groups in the U.S./Canada General Service structure.

Linking G.S.B. Class A trustee professionals: The committee received an update on the status of the Facebook page that has been established for Class A trustees from service structures around the world to share information and experience. The committee looks forward to continued discussion regarding the scope, content strategy and management of the Facebook group. The committee suggested that GSO look for potential opportunities to cross-post content that is available on the A.A.W.S. LinkedIn page.

G.S.B. Strategic Plan: The committee vice-chair will provide updates regarding the G.S.B. Strategic Plan items relevant to this committee as needed.

The meeting adjourned at 12:25 p.m.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

The committee recommended that Procedure #5 of the trustees' International Composition, Scope and Procedure which currently reads:

5. The committee reviews suggestions regarding international travel made by the Trip Consultation Team, which includes as its members: the chair of the General Service Board, both trustees-at-large, U.S. and Canada, general manager of GSO and the staff member on the International assignment.

Be revised to reflect the change made by the committee's February 2015 decision as follows:

5. The committee reviews suggestions regarding international travel made by the Trip Consultation Team, which includes as its members: the chair of the General Service Board, both trustees-at-large, U.S. and Canada, another trustee appointed by the General Service Board chair, general manager of GSO and the staff member on the International assignment.

The committee recommended that the General Service Board U.S./Canada contribute \$5,000 (US) to the REDELA Fund.

The committee recommended that advisory actions 32 and 33 of the 71st General Service Conference (listed below) be forwarded to the General Service Board and that a committee(s) be formed to discuss these actions and that both domestic (U.S./Canada) and International impact be considered in all discussions and implementation.

32. The U.S./Canada General Service Structure recognize online groups and encourage their participation, listing those groups who ask to be listed within the group's preferred district and area, with the default option being the location of the group's primary contact. This supersedes the 1997 Advisory Action that designated online groups as "International Correspondence Meetings."
33. The General Service Board form a committee to explore future possibilities for the participation of online groups in the U.S./Canada General Service structure.

Trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee

Saturday, July 31, 2021

The trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, July 31, 2021, at 1 p.m.

Present: Francis Gilroy, chairperson; Christine Carpenter, Linda Chezem, Ino Fernandez, Tom Hoban, Deborah Koltai, Jan Lembke, Paz Preciado, Kevin Prior, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, and James Hurst and Sandra Wilson, co-secretaries.

Also present: Gregg Talley and Derrick Johnson (Talley Management Group), Brenda Brown, Kathi Fowler, Grace Ralbovsky, Marita Rhinehart, Carolyn Walsh, Maria Morales-Lamm, Attallah Sophas and Mike Wilson (technical support).

Chairperson's remarks: The chairperson warmly welcomed everyone in attendance. The chairperson noted that he has been meeting virtually with Anne S. (chair of the 2022 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums) to keep her abreast of the trustee committee activities.

Appointment of vice-chairperson: The chair appointed Tom Hoban as vice-chairperson.

Approval of meeting report: The report of the January 30, 2021, meeting was approved.

Composition, Scope and Procedure: The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and requested the following editorial change:

- In the section "Scope," update *The A.A. Service Manual* reference to reflect the current version (e.g., year and page number).

The committee also requested the following change be implemented and brought back to the October 2021 meeting for review.

- In the section "Procedure," Revise paragraph number 3 to reflect the current accounting and budgeting procedures.

2021 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums report: The committee reviewed the 2021 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums Report.

The committee discussed the Conference committee consideration regarding use of the Lord's Prayer and agreed that a survey distributed to the Fellowship may be the best method to gather wider sharing from the Fellowship regarding the use of the Lord's Prayer at International Conventions; however, the committee agreed it best to table implementation until 2022/2023.

The committee reviewed the Conference committee considerations on how to attract first time attendees to Regional Forums, including using the Meeting Guide app, continuing to use videoconferencing technology to reach a broad audience, and conducting workshops in either Spanish or French.

Part II—Regional Forums

Staff report: The committee accepted the staff report as presented.

The Regional Forums video, also available at www.aa.org/pages/en_US/regional-and-local-forums, was shown to the committee.

Review Regional/Local Forums schedule 2021-2023: The committee reviewed the schedule and discussed the process of determining dates and locations for the 2021-2023 Regional Forums schedule.

Review preliminary board schedule for 2022 Regional Forums: The committee reviewed and accepted the 2022 Regional Forums Board/Staff Preliminary Schedule as presented.

Virtual pan-continental Special Forum: The committee inquired about the planning committee composition for the pan-continental Special Forum targeting certain international and U.S./Canada remote communities to be held in December. The Regional Forums assignment will work with the international assignment, Meetings, Travel and Events (METS) department, and the trustees-at-large in the event planning. The staff secretary will continue to update the committee as the planning progresses.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the virtual pan-continental Special Forum targeting certain international and U.S./Canada remote communities be held on December 11, 2021.

Part III—International Conventions

Staff report: The committee accepted the staff report as presented.

2025 International Convention initial planning thoughts: The committee invited the 2025 International Convention consultant to attend the meeting and share his initial thoughts regarding planning for the 2025 International Convention – from business and policy standpoints. Because so much has changed in travel and events and continuing uncertainty surrounding the Covid Delta variant, there are key planning components that require consideration, but it is also an opportunity to reimagine the International Convention and determine how best to create an engaging and accessible event. Points discussed included:

- It is suggested that we begin to collect data to get a sense from the Fellowship as to travel, attending large events, attending hybrid events, etc. The collection of data should continue throughout the planning process so that we can remain nimble in our planning.
- A 20-30% decrease in corporate global travel has impacted the hospitality industry (i.e., hotels closing and resulting in reduced room counts). We may need to consider whether to implement a registration cut-off to ensure that we can meet the lodging needs of the attendees.
- More and more events are offering a hybrid component. We need to determine if we want to plan a hybrid component to the International Convention. This is a decision that will need to be made in time to allow appropriate planning.
- Because of rising production costs, we may need to consider an increase in registration fees. Conversely, if we develop a hybrid component, we may be able to offer a reduced “virtual” registration fee.

The committee had a thoughtful discussion and requested that the Convention consultant provide additional information regarding current social events, changing trends, etc., that will help the committee determine next steps. The committee requested that this information be submitted for their October 2021 meeting.

The committee also inquired as to the requirements to cross the border into Vancouver. The Convention consultant will keep the committee apprised of any developments as the planning process moves closer to the Convention date.

Review 2025 Convention Consultant Selection report: The committee reviewed the 2025 International Convention Consultant Selection Report. The committee was informed that the RFI/RFP process for the 2030 International Convention consultant would begin in 2023.

Al-Anon participation in 2025 International Convention: The committee reviewed the invitation letter from the GSB chair to the Al-Anon/Alateen Family Groups Board chair. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Al-Anon/Alateen be invited to participate in A.A.’s 2025 International Convention in Vancouver, BC, Canada. Al-Anon’s participation will be based on their participation in Toronto (2005), San Antonio (2010), Atlanta (2015) and what was planned for Detroit (2020) – unfortunately cancelled due to the impact of Covid-19.

Name That Theme 2025 International Convention: The committee was informed that we have received over 100 suggested themes for A.A.’s 90th Anniversary in Vancouver. The deadline is coming up fast: let us hear from you by October 15, 2021.

The meeting adjourned at 2:45 p.m.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the virtual pan-continental Special Forum targeting certain international, and U.S./Canada remote communities be held on December 11, 2021.
2. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Al-Anon/Alateen be invited to participate in A.A.'s 2025 International Convention in Vancouver, BC, Canada. Al-Anon's participation will be based on their participation in Toronto (2005), San Antonio (2010), Atlanta (2015) and Detroit (2020) – unfortunately cancelled due to the impact of Covid-19.

Trustees' Literature Committee
Saturday, July 31, 2021

The trustees' Literature Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, July 31, 2021 at 4:00 p.m.

Present: Deborah Koltai, chair; Beau Bush, Amalia Castillo, Vera Farrell, Cindy French, Katie Heilmann, Mike Lewis, Al Mooney, Marita Rhinehart, Carolyn Walsh, Bob Wilcox, and Irene Donoso, secretary.

Also present: Brenda Brown, Cathi Clark, Jimmy Dean, Julia Dillon, Kathi Fowler, James Hurst, Tom Hoban, Mike Lewis, Nancy McCarthy, David Rosen, Ames Sweet, Craig Weidner, and Sandra Wilson.

Chair's remarks: Deborah Koltai warmly welcomed all committee members and guests with a special thanks to appointed committee members, Amalia Castillo and Katie Heilmann, who will serve another year on the committee. The chair also gave special thanks to GSO staff secretaries and GSO's publishing director and executive editor for all their work. The chair noted with appreciation the 71st General Service Conferences' enthusiasm to ensure that we effectively serve the Fellowship.

Appointment of vice-chair: The chair appointed Al Mooney vice-chair of the committee.

Composition, Scope and Procedure: The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and made no changes.

Report: The report from the January 31, 2021, meeting was approved.

Staff report: The staff report was accepted.

General Service Board Strategic Plan (July 2019): The committee reviewed the General Service Board Strategic Plan, updated July 2019. The committee noted that the trustees' Literature committee-related goals are within the purview of the A.A.W.S. Publishing committee with efforts underway to meet the goals in the Publishing department. These goals include "inventory of materials and services with an eye for inclusion and acceptance," and "review of A.A. literature for targeted audiences."

The committee agreed that the chair will follow up with overall Board approach to the Strategic Plan reporting and provide an update at the October 2021 meeting.

Review of the 71st General Service Conference advisory actions pertinent to this committee: The committee reviewed the list of 2021 Conference Committee on Literature advisory actions. The chair expressed appreciation for the disposition notes included for each item in the background.

Review of the 71st General Service Conference committee considerations pertinent to this committee: The committee reviewed the list of 2021 Conference Committee on Literature committee considerations. The chair expressed appreciation for the disposition notes included for each item in the background.

Discuss “A.A.W.S. Policy on Conversion of Written Conference-approved Literature and Service Material into Video Format”: The committee reviewed the 71st General Service Conference advisory action that acknowledges and accepts the “A.A.W.S. Policy on Conversion of Written Conference-approved Literature and Service Material into Video Format,” which was approved in January 2020 by A.A.W.S.

The committee requested that the staff secretary forward a memo to the A.A.W.S. Board noting their acknowledgement of the advisory action and appreciation for the development of the policy.

Review draft language regarding safety and A.A. to be included in *Living Sober* and “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship”: The committee discussed the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature’s committee consideration regarding language on safety and A.A. to be included in *Living Sober* and “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship.”

The committee requested that the Publishing department review the suggestions related to accessibility and literacy levels of the draft language. The committee also requested that the phrase “our primary purpose” be included with “our common welfare” to convey that safety is part of A.A.’s primary purpose. The committee noted that this material is intended for every A.A. member and not only the newcomer.

The committee requested that the Publishing department bring back a progress report or draft language at the October 2021 meeting.

Progress report regarding development of a pamphlet based on A.A.’s Three Legacies: The committee discussed the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature’s committee consideration regarding development of a pamphlet based on A.A.’s Three Legacies. The committee noted the suggestions related to the length of the pamphlet, the need for more relatable and accessible language. The committee agreed that the chair will reach out to the incoming Conference Committee on Literature chair to explore if more details on the suggested changes might be shared.

The committee requested that the Publishing department provide a progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Progress report regarding the pamphlet “Twelve Steps Illustrated”: The committee discussed the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature’s committee consideration regarding the pamphlet “Twelve Steps Illustrated.” The committee received a verbal

update from the Publishing department and expressed their appreciation for the work being done.

The committee requested that the Publishing department provide a written progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Progress report regarding the pamphlet “Twelve Concepts Illustrated”: The committee discussed the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature’s committee consideration regarding the pamphlet “Twelve Concepts Illustrated.” The committee received a verbal update from the Publishing department including a favorable review for a video available through the A.A. structure of Great Britain on the Twelve Concepts.

The committee requested that the Publishing department provide a link to the video from the Great Britain service structure on the Twelve Concepts along with a written progress report for review at the October 2021 meeting.

Progress report regarding the pamphlet “Too Young?”: The committee discussed the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature’s committee consideration regarding the pamphlet “Too Young?” The committee received a verbal update from the Publishing department that referenced a print to video project which is budgeted for 2022 for this item.

The committee requested the Publishing department provide a written progress report with an update on a script for the video format of the pamphlet for review at the October 2021 meeting.

Progress report regarding the pamphlet “Young People in A.A.”: The committee discussed the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature’s committee consideration regarding the pamphlet “Young People in A.A.” including additional suggestions to foster a greater diversity of stories and images of members. The committee received a verbal report from the Publishing Department which included the request for more specifics regarding the suggestions. The committee agreed that the chair will gather information from the incoming Conference Committee on Literature chair for more details on the suggestions.

The committee expressed their appreciation for the draft version and work done up to this point, noting that the pamphlet accomplishes an engaging visual representation of A.A. recovery experience. The committee noted that the pamphlet should offer ways to find A.A. literature attuned with the targeted audience and suggested additional items be included in the resource listing, such as the link to the A.A.W.S. YouTube channel and AA Grapevine books and others.

The committee requested that the chair provide an update on suggestion details and that the Publishing department provide written progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Discuss the existing version of the pamphlet “Twelve Traditions Illustrated”: The committee discussed the 2021 advisory action and the Conference Committee on Literature’s committee consideration regarding the update of the pamphlet of “The Twelve Traditions Illustrated.”

The committee acknowledged the 2021 Conference advisory action that approved the updated version of this pamphlet, “Experience Has Taught Us: An Introduction to Our Twelve Traditions,” as a distinct piece of literature addressing a different audience and serving a different purpose.

The committee agreed with continuing publication and distribution of the existing “Twelve Traditions Illustrated” pamphlet. The committee also noted the potentially offensive language and visuals which contributed to the original request to revise, and the possible need for revision in this item.

The committee agreed to continue discussions at the October 2021 meeting.

Discuss update of the pamphlet “A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic”: The committee discussed the 2021 advisory action regarding the pamphlet “A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic” stating that the pamphlet be updated to include fresh stories and a new title that is respectful and inclusive.

The committee noted considerations of inclusivity such as French and Spanish language black communities, as well as the limited scope of population defined as “African-American,” such as the black community in Canada and the Caribbean.

The committee noted the importance of participation from members of A.A. from the primary target audiences in the process of updating this pamphlet. The chair requested that committee member, Vera F., establish a working group and lead the implementation of a process for the pamphlet update.

The scope of the working group on the update of the pamphlet “A.A. for the Black and African-American” pamphlet is as follows:

- 1) Include a diverse group of A.A. members from the target audiences who can bring perspectives from a variety of ethnic, geographic, linguistic and age perspectives.
- 2) Solicit broad input on the current pamphlet and needed improvements, to inform the development of priorities for new stories from these diverse cultural perspectives.
- 3) Develop a method of outreach to foster significant amounts of submitted material.
- 4) Develop a process for selecting received stories.
- 5) Work toward development of a respectful and inclusive title.

The committee requested that the staff secretary support Vera’s efforts and that a working group progress report be provided at the October 2021 meeting.

Discuss update of the pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American”: The committee discussed the 2021 advisory action regarding the pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American Alcoholic.”

The committee noted the importance of participation from members of A.A. from the primary target audience in the process for updating this pamphlet.

To support a potential committee consultant and working group, the committee requested that the Publishing department gather background material including distribution rates of the pamphlet as well as written reviews for suggested improvements to the existing pamphlet from members of the primary target audience. The committee requested that Carolyn W., Irma V. and Marita R. be asked to share connections with A.A. members from indigenous communities and nations throughout the U.S./Canada service structure.

The committee requested that the Publishing department provide a progress report and that the secretary include background material for review during the October 2021 meeting.

Discuss the development of a draft Fourth Edition of the book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*: The committee discussed the 2021 advisory action regarding the development of a draft Fourth Edition of the book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*.

The committee acknowledged the challenges to create a book in a language that encompasses the diversity of the Spanish speaking population. The committee noted the importance of the Publishing department and GSO’s Spanish editor as important resources to support the development effort.

The committee noted the importance of participation from members of A.A. from the primary target audience. The committee also noted the efficacy of a workgroup instead of a subcommittee.

The chair requested that appointed committee member (ACM) Amalia C. establish a working group to lead the implementation for the creation of the Fourth Edition of the Spanish language Big Book. The committee acknowledged the value of Amalia’s expertise as a native Spanish speaker, three years’ experience as an ACM on the committee and her effective guidance and coordination for the development of the pamphlet “Hispanic Women in A.A.”

The committee agreed to the scope of the working group on the development of a draft Fourth Edition of the Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, to be as follows:

- 1) Include a diverse group of A.A. members from the target audiences who can bring perspectives from a variety of ethnic, geographic, dialect and age perspectives.
- 2) Solicit input on the needed improvements for stories to be relevant to the target audiences.
- 3) Discuss and solicit input if needed to define themes for sections of stories.

- 4) Develop a method of outreach to foster significant amounts of submitted material.
- 5) Develop a process for selection of personal stories.
- 6) Ascertain which editorial elements of the revision are maintained by the GSO Publishing department.
- 7) Work with publishing to ensure a review of the basic text translation that encompasses the diversity of the Spanish speaking population
- 8) Utilize other related work as needed to optimize the development of a draft version of the book.

The committee requested that the staff secretary support Amalia's efforts and that a working group progress report be provided at the October 2021 meeting.

Discuss the development of a draft version of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous (Fourth Edition)*, translated into plain and simple language which is accessible and relatable to as wide of an audience as possible: The committee discussed the 2021 advisory action to develop a draft version of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous (Fourth Edition)*, translated into plain and simple language which is accessible and relatable to as wide of an audience as possible. The committee reviewed background provided by the Publishing department and recognized that a timeline spanning several years is expected to consider for the possible completion date of this project.

The committee asked the Publishing department to work closely with the subcommittee in the development of draft content using three chapters of interest such as Chapter Five of the Big Book.

The chair appointed a subcommittee on the development of a plain and simple language Big Book and research of workbook development consideration to include Carolyn W., chair, John W. and Mike L. with the following scope:

- 1) Research various study guide workbook tools including those from proposed agenda items.
- 2) Review feedback from the Fellowship on the RIPTAB video.
- 3) Coordinate with the Publishing department (PD) to oversee and develop feedback related to:
 - a. Topics of direction and scope as requested by PD
 - b. Content of RFP (desired samples)
 - c. Any limits to the content to be translated
 - d. Review of samples and PD recommended vendors
 - e. Other work as needed to support the PD and implementation of the advisory action

The committee noted that the scope of the Subcommittee on The Development of the Plain and Simple Language Big Book and Research of Workbook Development includes two topics, one stemming from a 2021 advisory action and another from a 2021 consideration of the Conference Committee on Literature.

The committee requested that the subcommittee provide a progress report for the 2021 October meeting.

Consider requests to develop study guide workbooks for A.A.: The committee discussed the following 2021 Conference Committee on Literature consideration:

That the development of workbooks to help study the program of Alcoholics Anonymous, as reflected in the most current edition of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be considered and that a feasibility report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

Additionally, the committee considered the following proposed agenda items:

- Consider creating an individualized workbook to accompany the Big Book
- Consider the development of a contemporary and comprehensive new workbook to study the Twelve Steps, Traditions and Concepts

The committee agreed to explore options for the potential development of a workbook for the program of A.A.

The chair appointed a subcommittee on the development of a plain and simple language Big Book and research of workbook development consideration to include Carolyn W., chair; John W. and Mike L. with the following scope:

- 1) Research various study guide workbook tools including those from proposed agenda items.
- 2) Review feedback from the Fellowship on the RIPTAB video.
- 3) Coordinate with the Publishing department (PD) to oversee and develop feedback related to:
 - a. Topics of direction and scope as requested by PD
 - b. Content of RFP (desired samples)
 - c. Any limits to the content to be translated
 - d. Review of samples and PD recommended vendors
 - e. Other work as needed to support the PD and implementation of the advisory action

The committee noted that the scope of the Subcommittee on The Development of the Plain and Simple Language Big Book and Research of Workbook Development includes two topics, one stemming from a 2021 advisory action and another from a 2021 consideration of the Conference Committee on Literature.

The committee requested that the subcommittee provide a progress report for the 2021 October meeting.

Discuss the development of a draft Fifth Edition of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*: The committee discussed the 2021 advisory action to develop a draft Fifth Edition of the book,

Alcoholics Anonymous.

The chair appointed a subcommittee on development of a draft Fifth Edition Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous* to include Beau B., chair; Katie H., Cindy F., and Marita R. with the following scope:

1. Assure adherence to previous advisory actions limiting changes to specific content
2. Foster widespread discussion and solicit input as needed to define themes for sections of stories to create balanced and relatable set of stories.
3. Review editorial elements of the draft version of the Fifth Edition are under the purview of the Publishing department, including a new foreword and an updated preface.
4. Develop a plan to understand and execute updates to expand on existing ideas in Appendices III and V as requested by the 71st CCL.
5. Develop a plan to oversee a broad process of solicitation of stories.
6. Other work as needed related to optimizing the development of the draft version of the Fifth Edition Big Book.

The committee requested that the subcommittee provide a progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Discuss GSO Publishing updates per the A.A.W.S. print policy: The committee discussed GSO Publishing updates per the A.A.W.S. print policy. The committee noted that these updates were approved in January 2021 by the A.A.W.S Board and the trustees' Literature Committee at that time.

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature the draft update of the pamphlet, "Is A.A. for You?"

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature the draft update of the pamphlet, "Is there an Alcoholic in Your Life?"

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature the draft update of the pamphlet, "Frequently Asked Questions about A.A."

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature the draft update of the pamphlet, "This is A.A."

Discuss A.A.W.S.' print policy: The committee discussed A.A.W.S.' print policy. The committee reviewed the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature consideration which expressed support for a more defined process for review and approval of the pamphlet updates as well as the suggestion to include the GSO Publishing department workflow and literature matrix in the background for pamphlet updates per the print policy.

The committee agreed that the chair will research options for possible clarifications and improvements and report back to the October 2021 meeting.

Discuss literature matrix: The committee discussed the literature matrix and noted that consideration is underway for it to be included as background for the agenda item related to pamphlet updates per the A.A.W.S. print policy. The committee reviewed the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature consideration which requested consideration of a more defined process for review and approval of the pamphlet updates, as well as the suggestion to include the GSO Publishing department workflow and literature matrix in the background for pamphlet updates per the print policy.

The committee agreed that the chair will research options for possible clarifications and improvements and report back to the October 2021 meeting.

Review request to present the A.A. program of recovery in digital formats: The committee reviewed the request to present the A.A. program of recovery in digital formats.

The committee requested that the staff secretary obtain the Proposed Agenda Item form and Scoring Tool/Rating Sheet for the Equitable Workload Distribution (EDW) process for this agenda item and provide it to the committee as background.

The committee agreed to continue discussions at an additional committee meeting to be scheduled soon after this board weekend or at their October 2021 meeting.

Consider revising the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group" to reflect the importance of the group as a "spiritual entity" as stated in the Long Form of Tradition Five: The committee reviewed the agenda item to consider revising the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group," to reflect the importance of the group as a "spiritual entity" as stated in the Long Form of Tradition Five and noted the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature consideration with appreciation for the time limitation and workload mentioned. The committee **agreed to forward** the request to the 2022 General Service Conference.

The committee requested that the staff secretary obtain the Proposed Agenda Item form and Scoring Tool/Rating Sheet for the EDW process for this agenda item and provide it to the committee as background.

The committee agreed to continue discussions at an additional committee meeting to be scheduled soon after this board weekend or at their October 2021 meeting.

Consider revising text highlighting service roles at the group level in the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group": The committee reviewed the agenda item to consider revising text highlighting service roles at the group level in the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group" and noted the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature consideration with appreciation for the time limitation and workload mentioned. The committee **agreed to forward** the request to the 2022 General Service Conference.

The committee requested that the staff secretary obtain the Proposed Agenda Item form and Scoring Tool/Rating Sheet for the EDW process for this agenda item and provide it to the committee as background.

The committee agreed to continue discussions at an additional committee meeting to be scheduled soon after this board weekend or at their October 2021 meeting.

Consider the request to include a GSR preamble in the pamphlet “G.S.R.: Your Group’s Link to A.A. as a Whole”: The committee reviewed the agenda item to consider the request to include a GSR preamble in the pamphlet “G.S.R.: Your Group’s Link to A.A. as a Whole” and noted the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature consideration with appreciation for the time limitation and workload mentioned. The committee **agreed to forward** the request to the 2022 General Service Conference.

The committee requested that the staff secretary obtain the Proposed Agenda Item form and Scoring Tool/Rating Sheet for the EDW process for this agenda item and provide it to the committee as background.

The committee agreed to continue discussions at an additional committee meeting to be scheduled soon after this board weekend or at their October 2021 meeting.

Consider revising the pamphlet “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship” to reflect shared experience on service sponsorship: The committee reviewed the agenda item to consider the request to consider revising the pamphlet “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship” to reflect shared experience on service sponsorship and noted the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature consideration with appreciation for the time limitation and workload mentioned. The committee **agreed to forward** the request to the 2022 General Service Conference.

The committee requested that the staff secretary obtain the Proposed Agenda Item form and Scoring Tool/Rating Sheet for the EDW process for this agenda item and provide it to the committee as background.

The committee agreed to continue discussions at an additional committee meeting to be scheduled soon after this board weekend or at their October 2021 meeting.

Review progress report regarding strategy to make current literature accessible in all possible formats: The committee reviewed the verbal progress report provided by the Publishing department regarding making current literature accessible in all possible formats under the purview of A.A.W.S.

The committee appreciates the ongoing work and looks forward to a progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Review progress report regarding Literature Committee workbook: The committee reviewed the verbal progress report provided by the Publishing department regarding Literature Committee workbook.

The committee appreciates the ongoing work and looks forward to a progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Consider development of a pamphlet entitled "Experience, Strength and Hope: A.A. for the Transgender Alcoholic": The committee reviewed the agenda item to consider development of a pamphlet entitled "Experience, Strength and Hope: A.A. for the Transgender Alcoholic."

The committee agreed to continue discussions at an additional committee meeting to be scheduled soon after this board weekend or at their October 2021 meeting.

Consider development of a pamphlet entitled "Experience, Strength and Hope: A.A. for the Spanish-speaking LGBTQ Alcoholic": The committee reviewed the agenda item to consider development of a pamphlet entitled "Experience, Strength and Hope: AA for the Spanish-speaking LGBTQ Alcoholic."

The committee agreed to continue discussions at an additional committee meeting to be scheduled soon after this board weekend or at their October 2021 meeting.

The meeting adjourned at 6:36 p.m.

Trustees' Nominating Committee

Saturday, July 31, 2021

The trustees' Nominating Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, July 31, 2021, at 4 p.m.

Present: Jan Lembke, chair; Christine Carpenter, Linda Chezem, Josh Eggleston, Francis H. Gilroy, Trish LaNauze, Paz Preciado, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, and Diana Lewis, secretary.

Also present: Kathi Fowler, Stephanie Lyles, and Bob Wilcox.

Chair's remarks: The chair warmly welcomed all to the meeting.

Appointment of vice-chair: The chair appointed Christine Carpenter vice-chair of the committee.

Meeting report: The committee approved the January 30, 2021, April 11, 2021, and June 16, 2021 reports.

Staff report: The staff report was accepted.

Review Composition, Scope and Procedure: The committee agreed to table its review of their Composition, Scope and Procedure to their October 2021 meeting.

Calendar of events: The committee reviewed the calendar of events. The committee noted their review of candidates to fill vacancies on the General Service and corporate Boards.

Rotation schedule: The committee reviewed the current rotation schedule of trusted servants on the General Service Board, A.A. World Services and AA Grapevine Corporate Boards. The committee noted that five trustees will be rotating in 2022.

Status of appointed committee members (ACMs): The committee reviewed an update on the status of appointed committee members serving on trustees' committees of the General Service Board for the years 2021-2022. The committee noted that the ACM on the trustees' CPC-TA committee stepped down from this service position.

At their June 16, 2021, meeting the committee discussed the status of appointed committee members. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Kirk Holms of Las Vegas, NV and Morgan Biggs of New Orleans, LA be appointed to serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Public Information Committee commencing with the July 2021 General Service Board Weekend.

Discuss "Does A.A. Work?" Video: The committee received an update from an ad-hoc working group member for the video, "Does A.A. Work?" and noted a recent interview in

the “Alcoholism at Large” section of the AA Grapevine. The committee will provide feedback on possible ways that the video could be utilized and agreed to forward a memo back to the ad hoc working group that includes concerns and considerations.

Class A rotation: The committee continued their discussion of the rotation schedule of Class A trustees, noting the recent rotations following the General Service Conference and the current descriptions in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

Time commitment and recruitment of Class A trustees: The committee agreed to schedule an additional meeting to discuss this topic and agreed to broaden the topic to include the time commitment and recruitment of Class B trustees and directors on the affiliate corporate boards.

2021 Conference Committee on Trustees: The committee reviewed the report of the 2021 Conference Committee on Trustees.

Thread-based forums: The committee discussed the Conference Committee on Trustees committee consideration requesting the General Service Board to actively pursue the exploration of thread-based forums and new communication models to improve communication between the General Service Board and the Fellowship and agreed to take no action. The committee noted the additional demands on time that can develop throughout the year when using thread-based forums and the existing time commitment of General Service Board trustees. The committee also noted that the Communication Services department is exploring ways for the General Service Office to have instant communication with the Fellowship.

Procedures for partial or total reorganization of the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. or AA Grapevine Boards: The committee discussed a Conference Committee on Trustees committee consideration and memorandum on the revised “Procedures for a Partial or Complete Reorganization of the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. or AA Grapevine Boards,” requesting that the trustees’ Nominating Committee consider further review, with specific attention placed upon the time frame and procedure for the selection of regional trustees, and took no action. The committee noted the pace that our A.A. service structure makes changes and agreed that ample communication and planning would be available for areas to develop a selection procedure for regional trustees. The committee also agreed to make editorial changes to the revised “Procedures for a Partial or Complete Reorganization of the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. or AA Grapevine Boards” to mirror the updated Conference Charter. The committee agreed to forward the revised plan to the 2022 Conference Committee on Trustees.

Simple majority suggestion item: The committee reviewed and discussed a Conference coordinator memo communicating that trustees’ committees review the corresponding Conference committee’s recommendation that passed by a simple majority as a suggestion. The committee considered the following simple majority item:

The General Service Conference charge the General Service Board with the setup of quarterly virtual meetings of Conference Members, to begin following

the October 2021 General Service Board Weekend. These meetings would follow several weeks after each Quarterly Board Meeting, to allow Conference Members the opportunity to request additional information, ask clarifying questions, and to secure a greater sense of transparency.

The committee discussed the feasibility of a videoconference gathering in the Fall, following the October General Service Board meeting, and agreed to take no action. The committee discussed existing ways that our U.S./Canada service structure communicates and participates in a year-round process and expressed concern about taking away those opportunities between a region and area. The committee also noted existing opportunities that allow Conference committee members the opportunity to ask questions and request additional information, including, but not limited to, inviting General Service Board members to attend Conference committee meetings, Regional Forums, and special events held by service areas or regions. The committee also noted that the trustees' Conference Committee routinely discusses ways to improve communication with Conference members.

Electing trustee emeriti: The committee noted the recent virtual settings of the General Service Board and Conference and voted on a recommendation to nominate a newly rotating chair as trustee emeritus that did not pass. The committee noted the ways that rotating chairpersons of the General Service Board are designated as trustees emeriti and considered the option to create a procedure. The committee also noted a past subcommittee's recommendation to create a trustee emeriti procedure that failed. The committee also noted the description of the trustee emeriti role in *The A.A. Service Manual* that describes their role as a resource of corporate memory, past board decisions and the process used to reach a group conscience but does not provide details about how they are designated as trustees' emeriti.

The committee met in executive session from 6:21 p.m. to 6:39 p.m. (The committee also met in executive session on February 19, 2021, for a general service trustee nominee and AAGV board member recommendation as noted below.)

Executive Session

Unexpected board vacancy: On February 19, 2021, the committee voted via email to elect Paz Preciado as a general service trustee nominee and AAGV board member, following Tommi Hanley removing her name from the slate. The committee recommended to the General Service Board placing Paz Preciado on the slates of the 2021-2022 AAGV board of directors and the 2021-2022 General Service Board. Note: This recommendation was subsequently approved via email by the General Service Board.

AA Grapevine publisher candidate: The committee reviewed the preferred candidate of the AA Grapevine board for the AA Grapevine publisher position and was in support of their selection.

Nontrustee director candidates: The committee reviewed nontrustee director candidates selected by the A.A.W.S., Inc. and AA Grapevine, Inc. boards to interview and found them

all eligible for consideration except one.

Class A trustee search: The committee created a list of eight (8) Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee applicants to interview for two openings via videoconference.

Resume sheets for candidates: The committee discussed the current forms used in filling vacancies on the General Service Board, its corporate board affiliates, and some executive positions at the General Service Office and AA Grapevine. The committee noted the challenges using the form for candidate selections, and the range of software versions in the Fellowship. The committee requested that the General Service Office acquire software as soon as possible to create online forms to aide filling board vacancies.

GSB inventory of skills and background: The committee agreed to schedule an additional meeting to have this discussion.

The committee adjourned at 6:39p.m.

Recommendations

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Kirk Holms of Las Vegas, NV and Morgan Biggs of New Orleans, LA be appointed to serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Public Information Committee commencing with the July 2021 General Service Board Weekend.

Trustees' Public Information Committee
Saturday, July 31, 2021

The trustees' Public Information Committee met by videoconference on Saturday, July 31, 2021, at 1:00 p.m.

Present: Beau Bush, chairperson; Molly Anderson, Morgan Biggs, Vera Farrell, Cindy French, Coree Hogan, Kirk Holmes, Trish LaNauze, Nancy McCarthy, John Weis, Linda Chezem, Bob Wilcox and Patrick Claymore, staff secretary.

Also present: Clement Cann, Christopher Cavanaugh, Cathi Clark, Jimmy Dean, Josh Eggleston, Kathi Fowler, Tracey Godsil, Julie Gonzalez, Racy Joseph, Stephanie Lyles, Al Mooney, Alexandra Rosenmann, Attallah Sophas, Julisa Soriano, Craig Weidner and Mike Wilson (technical support).

Chair's remarks: The chair welcomed all in attendance.

Appointment of vice-chair: The chair appointed Trish LaNauze as vice-chair of the committee.

Report: The committee approved the January 30, 2021, meeting report.

Composition, Scope and Procedure: The committee reviewed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and tabled discussion of possible revisions to the October 2021 meeting.

2021 Conference Committee on PI advisory actions and committee considerations: The committee reviewed the list of the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information's advisory actions and committee considerations pertaining to the committee.

Staff report: The committee accepted the staff report. The committee noted the staff secretary's suggestion that committee members subscribe to Google alerts to help inform the work in developing public information messaging.

Communication Services department report: The committee accepted the Communication Services department report.

Public Information media platforms: The committee discussed public information media platforms, including reports provided to the committee on the following: the development of podcasts, the A.A.W.S. and AA Grapevine YouTube channels, Google Ads, the A.A.W.S. Meeting Guide app, and the GSO and AA Grapevine/La Viña websites.

The committee noted the ongoing need for enhanced cooperation between our corporations, related to the GSO and AA Grapevine/La Viña websites, A.A. World Services and AA Grapevine YouTube, and other digital assets. In addition, the committee

discussed the need to review and potentially adjust the scope of content and reporting mechanisms of website reports.

Google Ads: The committee discussed the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information committee consideration regarding Google Ads. The Communication Services department will work in tandem with trustees' Public Information Committee appointed committee members (ACMs) to implement and broaden the current efforts to reflect the suggestions detailed in the committee consideration. The committee expressed appreciation for the ongoing work and looks forward to reports to be provided to the October 2021 meeting.

The committee also reviewed the progress report on the development of A.A. podcasts. The committee discussed GSO's current efforts and looks forward to a progress report at the October 2021 meeting. The committee noted that all digital platform reports will be included as part of the PI Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP) review and strategy.

GSO Website: The committee reviewed and accepted the GSO 2021 first and second quarter website reports for aa.org.

AA Grapevine/La Viña Website: The committee reviewed and accepted the GSO 2021 first and second quarter website reports for the AA Grapevine/La Viña websites.

Public Service Announcements (PSAs):

Progress report on two new PSAs and updates to audio PSAs: The committee discussed a progress report on post-production efforts of the two 2021 Conference-approved PSAs. The committee looks forward to when the completed PSAs are made available to the Fellowship. In keeping with the PI advisory action, the committee looks forward to a progress report on the broadcast distribution and tracking of the two PSAs at the October 2021 meeting.

Relevance and Usefulness of Public Service Announcements: The committee reviewed the current video PSAs and found them to be relevant and useful and **agreed to forward** their findings to the 2022 Conference Committee on Public Information. The committee noted that while the content and messaging of the existing three PSAs *listed below remain relevant, the contact tag lines may need editorial updates to reflect consistent contact A.A. tag lines found in the recently produced PSAs to include Meeting Guide. The committee secretary shared that the tag lines in all radio PSAs have been updated in all three languages. The committee looks forward to the revised PSAs being made available on aa.org.

- Sobriety in A.A.: We made changes to stop drinking (PSA)
- Sobriety in A.A.: Opening doors to a life without drinking (PSA)
- La sobriedad en A.A.: Desde que logré mi sobriedad, tengo esperanza (ASP)

**Titles reflect SEO retitling*

Feasibility study on paid placement of PSA videos on streaming platforms: The committee discussed the PI advisory action that a feasibility study on paid placement of PSA videos on streaming platforms including, but not limited to, Netflix, Hulu, and YouTube be conducted. The committee looks forward to research conducted by GSO regarding these platforms at the October 2021 meeting.

Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP): The committee discussed the status of the PI CMP. The trustees' PI Committee will review and update the content and architecture of the CMP. The committee will utilize a working group style approach, involving all committee members focusing on content, review of messaging/communications, digital assets, services, roles and responsibilities involving the three corporations. Development of the Comprehensive Media Plan is an ongoing project.

Revision to the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings": The committee discussed the P.I. advisory action, "That the trustees' Public Information Committee revise the pamphlet 'Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings.'" The committee requested that the staff secretary, in cooperation with the staff members on the CPC and Accessibilities assignments, review the current version and provide suggestions for potential edits that may be helpful in PI and CPC efforts. The committee also noted the suggestion that focus is given to A.A. messaging to diverse public audiences in non-A.A. settings and to include a section on media training/press interviews. The committee looks forward to reviewing these suggestions at the October 2021 meeting.

The committee also discussed the 2021 PI committee consideration that a PowerPoint presentation be developed for PI and CPC committees for the purpose of providing shared experience on "how to" present about A.A. at non-A.A. events. The committee looks forward to a progress report on this effort.

Revision to "Message to Teenagers": The committee discussed the PI advisory action, "That the trustees' Public Information Committee revise the flyer 'A Message to Teenagers' to better reflect carrying the A.A. message to young people." In addition to revisions to language in the twelve questions and updated graphics, the committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee provide suggestions on what the best format would be to present information contained in the flyer. The committee noted that suggestions regarding the flyer will be included in the CMP discussions. The committee also discussed the possibility of having a young peoples' focus group to provide relevant feedback. The staff member will provide a progress report at the October 2021 meeting.

Public Information pamphlets and materials: The committee discussed the PI 2021 committee consideration encouraging a continued review of the PI pamphlets/service materials and requesting that a comprehensive report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Public Information including suggestions and input related to which PI pamphlets/materials may need revision, editorial updates, new formats or possible retirement to make room for improved public information messaging tools. The

committee determined that the review will be included as part of the ongoing development of the Comprehensive Media Plan.

"Understanding Anonymity": The committee discussed the PI 2021 committee consideration that GSO Publishing conduct editorial updates to the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" to reflect current technology terminologies and service resources at its next printing. The staff secretary will send a memorandum to GSO Publishing requesting these updates.

The committee also noted that more substantive updates may need to be considered to reflect a more current depiction of how members – as members -- utilize social media in service committee efforts, at the group level, and in Fellowship.

Proposed agenda item "to create a new form of communication" to address anonymity on social media: The committee continued to discuss and review the proposed agenda item requesting "to create a new form of communication to address anonymity on social media." The committee tabled the discussion and will either meet soon after the board weekend to continue discussion or will discuss at the October 2021 meeting.

A.A. Membership Survey: The committee discussed the 2021 committee consideration regarding the A.A. Membership Survey methodology report.

The committee recommended that the staff secretary moves forward and engage the professional survey methodologist, to conduct a focused review and analysis of the A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire at a cost not to exceed \$8,000 (the current amount in the reforecast 2021 trustees' PI budget category for this item).

The meeting adjourned at 3:40 p.m.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

That the staff secretary moves forward and engage the professional survey methodologist, to conduct a focused review and analysis of the A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire at a cost not to exceed \$8,000 (the current amount in the reforecast 2021 trustees' PI budget category for this item).

General Sharing Session

Friday, July 30, 2021

Francis G., Northeast Regional Trustee, warmly welcomed everyone to the General Sharing Session at the General Service Board Weekend. Francis mentioned that, based on the archives, we had only discussed tonight's specific topic once before. The topic was: "The Minority Voice."

Irene D., GSO Staff, presented on the subtopic: "The Voice of the Minority." She started the sharing letting us know she is a bi-lingual staff member and one of her professional backgrounds is that of a Spanish editor. The point Irene started with was grounding us in the spiritual aspect of Chapter Seven, "Working with Others," from our Big Book. Highlighting the fact that when Bill wrote the word "others" there may have been no way he could have imagined how inclusive we would be, or we still could be. Irene referenced the recent Conference advisory actions changing the A.A. Preamble to be more inclusive and moving forward with a plain language Big Book to overcome barriers with current and prospective members.

"The Accessibilities and Remote Communities assignment has changed its name several times in the last ten years to accommodate the growing list of barriers that exist between the A.A. message and the alcoholic out there." Irene brought up the efforts of local entities to use basket money to provide interpretation and translation, also mentioning GSO involvement with the North/South Connections Forum that helped connect remote communities in the northern hemisphere with the southern hemisphere, making sure that language was no barrier.

Irene said, "We need to meet the 'other' where they are at. It is hard to understand the needs of a population if you do not try to engage with them. Some questions to consider are 'Do we perhaps avoid sitting at a table with a minority that makes us feel uncomfortable? Or perhaps our expectations when we select trusted servants are not suitable for other cultures, social groups? Are we creating service material about certain cultures without including the members of those cultures?'"

Seeing a lack of diversity in our service structure, Irene expressed gratitude for the General Service Board ad hoc committee on encouraging minority participation up and down the "service triangle." As we look around the room, we can clearly see the ad hoc is warranted both logically and spiritually.

One of the duties of the Accessibility desk is to help with Spanish and French correspondence and Irene described the importance of having a language desk at the GSO. She also spoke about how, at the beginning of the pandemic, it was beautiful to see virtual groups welcome those members with disabilities and make their groups accessible while brick and mortar meetings were not available. The hope is that all virtual groups, online and phone, will continue to make meetings accessible to those with disabilities or other challenges. Irene conveyed how some areas have sadly shared that

Hispanic participation has decreased since the pandemic. “How could this happen with such active A.A. members?” Few linguistic districts and Hispanic GSRs were connected with GSO via email. Irene said, “Some years ago, the Grapevine office opened a simple, inexpensive channel of communication with the Hispanic communities through text messaging. Hopefully we continue to ask those communities we serve how to best keep in touch.” Additional questions to ask ourselves: “Do we know how to communicate with minority populations? Do we know what they need to support their Twelfth Step work?” Irene shared a personal story of meeting a wonderful, trusted servant at a Regional Forum. This person asked Irene what happened at the General Service Conference. Irene enthusiastically shared that she looks forward to the day when instead of asking about the Conference that person will be there serving as delegate.

Jimmy D., A.A.W.S. board chair, continued the sharing, coming right out to the principle of the “minority opinion” by reframing it as the “minority experience.” Hearing the minority opinion is essential to achieve an informed group conscience. Jimmy shared that from the inception of our Fellowship it has been proven time and again that listening intently to those whose opinion did not prevail has helped to assure the future of our program. The book *Alcoholics Anonymous* was advanced into reality by what could be defined as the minority opinion. Anonymity at the public level was at one time early in our Fellowship classified as the minority voice. Staying poor and paying our own way was not the “party line” in the early days and weeks of what Bill called “the movement.” In many of these examples it is not quite certain that the group conscience was informed or even collected to the extent that we would demand today. We wanted something and we were willing to go to any lengths to get it or do it. Bill cleaned this up quite a bit and summarized by stating “trial and error has produced a rich experience.”

Jimmy shared a learning experience with a sponsee surrounding minority opinion. Referring to the Fifth Concept as the foundation for the guarantee that the minority will always be heard in A.A., Jimmy also stated some of Bill W.’s shared experience proving “protection” against the uninformed, misinformed, hasty, or angry majority.

Jimmy was emphatic that “this room of trusted servants – trustees, directors, staffs, and committee members – are specifically directed by Concept V to file minority reports when it is felt that the majority is in error, and in the case of a matter considered to grievously impact the Fellowship as a whole we are duty-bound to present a minority report to the Conference sitting in their capacity as the group conscience of A.A.”

Jimmy shared that, as important as this principle is, during his time on the board it seems the principle of minority opinion has been mentioned very little or not at all. An important fact Jimmy described was about the tools to allow for the minority opinion, such as available resources and including them in the discussion. Jimmy shared that “A natural by-product of this engagement is an informed minority voice; whether it is also misinformed or misguided matters not. Once the churning of a conscience begins, the cream always eventually rises to the top.” Jimmy quoted Bernard Smith regarding the need of a Conference to ensure that changes within A.A. come only as a response to the

needs and wants of all A.A. and not of any few. Concept Five guarantees we are sure to engage in thorough debate. With this said he is inspired to hear from the minority voice.

Francis thanked both presenters and invited attendees to share. One trustee linked being welcomed to A.A. with not having to conform to the principle of the minority opinion. The minority voice allows us to have not just a group conscience but an informed group conscience. Another participant expressed an experience with a Japanese group in the United States and how just being a minority community can be having a minority voice. A trustee told a story of how he almost left service when he was on the area committee because he was hearing impaired but shared how his area started supplying equipment to help all participate.

A staff member expressed the prudence of a minority opinion being hard to hear but necessary. An ACM reinforced the importance of the fact that it is our duty and responsibility to express the minority opinion and how it is a facet of leadership. A director shared how afraid they were of sharing with someone who spoke a different language and how they worked through that starting with just saying "hello." A trustee revealed the importance of interpretation and hearing all voices. Another director described how, to keep the meeting flowing, her area sometimes counseled the chairs to not ask for the minority opinion, but when the minority opinion is honored, it is so powerful. The spiritual principle of inclusivity is to include everything, all voices, all opinions, and it is by that principle we have an informed group conscience.

A staff member punctuated the need to open the channel of communication no matter who we are talking to. Another staff member expressed passion for the group conscience and the necessity of the minority opinion; coupled with her step work, it helps give her the confidence to speak up. A trustee shared how she will be visiting with a local indigenous tribal chief and noted the lack of indigenous people in our rooms and shared that A.A. needs to feel like a safe place for all people to share.

A director mentioned that as a Latino in South Beach he didn't feel like a minority, the group was diverse and he was always welcome, but that it is us and not them who make up the minority opinion and the ability to listen to the minority opinion. Lastly, a director expressed trying to be mindful of not reducing the spiritual principle of minority opinion to just a business meeting procedure as it needs to be much more, as outlined in our Warranties.

As the topic transitioned to the idea of a returning to a "town meeting style" for the General Sharing Session, our General Service Board chair mentioned during the birthing of this great organization there was famine, the great depression and still we thrived, and that it was a great time for A.A. She asked how we can emerge from the Covid catastrophe and use it to help us. It will be sacrifice and unity that will make sure we are here for all who suffer. We gather facts, we designate the time for full participation, and we honor the minority opinion. Reciprocating respect from majority to the minority is our standard.

The general manager took the stage and fully introduced the “town meeting style” discussion and invited ideas pertaining to that of restructuring the General Sharing Session and our 1728 meeting to support unity and carry us forward. He shared his belief that a “town meeting style” session would help for a fully informed principle-oriented discussion. A brief history of the “town meeting style” from our Eleventh Concept was shared as well as a reference to an archived document from the Policy Committee and its idea of a “town hall format” where everyone could express their opinion, but no vote taken.

The floor was opened for sharing: One director stated that they would enthusiastically support this idea. A staff member mentioned supporting meaningful discussion whatever the restructure is; and mentioned an exclusive meeting, and when matters that affect A.A. as a whole are discussed behind closed doors without all the information and the secretaries who write the committee reports and staff who are part of the Twelve Concepts, the process is not within our shared experience. A trustee conveyed the importance of remembering delegated authority and the Board meetings are for the trustees, as trustees do not go to the staff meetings. A trustee was inquiring about the history of the General Policy Committee, however in full support for us all to get together and discuss wide ranging topics. Another trustee passionately supports the idea of having a unified meeting. This meeting is a simple principle of asking for help.

Sharing came to a conclusion with the general manager wanting to make sure it was understood the spirit is that of creating a transparent, trusting, useful and safe place to communicate and participate with each other to help us with our primary purpose. However, we do not want to lose sight of the importance of the 1728 meeting's intent and how useful the meeting is to the Class A trustees, both new and experienced.

General Service Board Sharing Session
Theme: “The Minority Voice”

Presentation: “Our Flag for the Future – The Minority Voice”
Jimmy D., A.A. World Services, Inc., Chair
July 30, 2021

I want to thank my fellow Regional ‘litter mate’ Francis (we came on the board together in 2019) for the loving invitation to share for a few minutes on the minority voice, sometimes described as the ‘minority opinion’ although in my years in AA it has more often than not been the expression of ‘minority experience’. Respect for the minority is a cherished and quite fundamental aspect of participation in AA and hearing from the minority is certainly absolutely essential in arriving at an informed group conscience. I am hopeful for both my benefit and yours that I don’t stray too far from my assigned topic – some might call it ‘freelancing’ but an old Al-Anon that I knew and loved who had been in the Family Groups since the Auxiliary just waiting for Al-Anon to form used to say ‘you lost the baby’ when your talk went rogue LOL.

From the inception of our Fellowship, it has been proven time and again that listening intently to those whose opinion did not prevail has helped to assure the future of our program. The book Alcoholics Anonymous was advanced into reality by what could be defined as the minority opinion. Anonymity at the public level was at one time early in our Fellowship classified as the minority voice. Staying poor and paying our own way was not the ‘party line’ in the early days and weeks of what Bill called ‘the movement’. In many of these examples it is not quite certain that the group conscience was informed or even collected to the extent that we would demand today. We wanted something and we were willing to go to any lengths to get it or do it. Bill cleaned this up quite a bit and summarized by stating ‘trial and error has produced a rich experience’.

Years ago, one of the men I sponsor was elected group chair and called me to get some pointers prior to chairing his first business meeting. His home group at the time was somewhat ‘loose’ in its structure, especially compared to my home group filled with amateur parliamentarians. We talked about the process of a motion and second, moving into clarification and discussion. I mentioned the possibility of calling the question and how that would unfold. Once the vote was taken, I took particular pains to stress the importance of asking for the minority voice. I remember I reiterated that several times during the conversation and stressed that, in AA, we always listen to those not in the majority. I believed my pigeon was well-prepared and, knowing me at 7 or 8 years of sobriety, thought for a moment how much that group had been helped by having a group chair with such effective sponsorship. The next morning my guy called me to give the report. “It was an absolute disaster” he whined into the phone. I asked him – did you ask for the motion and the second; did you have thorough discussion; did you take the vote; and most importantly did you ask for the minority? He answered all my questions in the affirmative. I then asked what was so disastrous? He said the business meeting lasted from 9 pm until midnight because they kept voting, listening to the minority, motioning to

revote, lather, rinse, repeat ☹ I had to make an amend to my sponsee that I had failed to tell him that after the first pass of that process it was done. Lesson learned.

We often cite the essay on the Fifth Concept as the foundation for the guarantee that the minority will always be heard in AA. I am well acquainted with the membership gathered in this sharing session and would not presume to think I can draw out components of the essay that have not already become basic tenets of your AA service lives. Bill's experience, which certainly parallels my own, is that the minority voice frequently can be right and that even when it is partially or completely wrong, we are well-served in that it compels thorough debate. He uses the word 'protection' against an uninformed, misinformed, hasty, or angry majority. This room of trusted servants – trustees, directors, staffs, and committee members – are specifically directed by Concept V to file minority reports when it is felt that the majority is in error. In the case of a matter considered to grievously impact the Fellowship as a whole we are duty-bound to present a minority report to the Conference sitting in their capacity as the group conscience of AA.

As a trusted servant at this level, I find this minority responsibility to be of paramount importance and yet it seems it has, in my time on the board, been mentioned very little or not at all. Certainly, there has been a level of respect among my peers in my rotation that has complimented the formation of an informed group conscience among us in committees or when sitting as a board. I would also say that I have experienced no fear of reprisal for expressing my opinion and my experience on the subject at hand, albeit sometimes in the minority, and more often than not we have achieved substantial or complete unanimity after lengthy discussion and this past year, and a half hasn't been a 'cake walk'.

So, when I went back through the essay to formulate my thoughts and gather my experiences to put this little talk together, I realized that the effectiveness of the minority voice absolutely depends on all available resources being included in the discussion. Of course, we know that having the membership of AA engaged in a common discussion is logistically impossible thus the delegation of duties and responsibilities and, yes, the ugly word authority from the groups to the Conference to the General Service Board to the affiliate boards and to our Tradition 8 special workers. Logically that would mean to me that, whenever possible, when discussing matters that impact the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole or when trying to fulfill our duty to seek clarity and guidance in our vision for the future of AA, we offer a seat at the table to all those trusted servants to guarantee to the best of our ability that our conscience is informed. A natural by-product of this engagement is an informed minority voice; whether it is also misinformed or misguided matters not. Once the churning of a conscience begins the cream always eventually rises to the top.

When I served as delegate in Panel 59, I came to the Conference knowing I was informed and not instructed. I believed (rightly so) that my Area trusted me to carry their voices but also trusted me to listen as if I had no opinion. I'd like to tell you I did that perfectly but other Panel 59 delegates in this room might disagree. I remember using my minority voice – a vote of ONE in the minority in my first year as delegate, followed up by a floor action

to rescind the decision that I felt was completely wrong. I didn't think the decision in and of itself was so objectionable, but I was diametrically opposed to the way we arrived at it. I was certain that some voices that should have been part of the informed group conscience had not been included in the conversation. At some point the ability to have 'a fireside chat' among all the trusted servants to whom that right had been delegated was superseded by process or a set agenda or time constraints. I could not see any way that any opposing viewpoint had been given opportunity to be vetted, or in AA speak, the minority voice had not been heard because it had not been initially included in the conversation.

Bern Smith counseled in 1954 that we needed the Conference '...to ensure that changes within AA come only as a response to the needs and the wants of all AA, and not of any few.' The roadmap to bring this to fruition via our principles is Tradition 2, which absolutely depends on as fully an informed conscience as possible. This certainly infers that any and all voices that can be assembled are included in expressions of both the majority and, as importantly, the minority viewpoints as we discuss the benefits and liabilities of the subject at hand. As the essay on Concept 5 guarantees we are sure to engage in thorough debate. I am intrigued by the fact that, over the decades, this body of trusted servants may have at certain times extended past the principle of 'least possible organization' and sacrificed the fireside chat in order to get three more items on the agenda. I am as aware as anyone about the untenable amount of work to be done but we have experienced time and again that 'stop, look, listen' to all sides of the situation is infinitely more beneficial to the long-term health and well-being of AA. It takes time to hear all sides – our principles reinforce this is time well-spent.

In the 9 or so minutes I have been talking the genesis of a group conscience has begun to form – as yet unarticulated. Some of the room might venture 'job well done' and others who, based on my experience are in the majority, are scratching their heads thinking 'he lost the baby'. I for one am excited to hear from the minority this evening.

Much AA love for all of you,

Jimmy

General Service Board Sharing Session
Theme: "The Minority Voice"

Presentation: "The Minority Voice"
Irene D., G.S.O. Staff Member
July 30, 2021

Good afternoon my name is Irene Donoso, and I am an alcoholic. I have the privilege to work as a G.S.O. Staff Member on the Accessibilities and Remote Communities desk since July 2019. This weekend I am rotating to the Literature desk. There are many professional backgrounds among the 11 Staff Members, mine is 25 years in Publishing, as a Spanish Editor.

I am especially grateful to Francis Gilroy and Jeff Wine for giving me the opportunity to share about the topic "The Minority Voice."

When the invitation to present on this topic came, I thought a good start was to go back to the chapter "Working with Others" in the Big Book: "Practical experience shows that nothing will so much ensure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics." For me and for many alcoholics this sentence always illuminates the spiritual foundation of our program of recovery. Today the word "other" calls my attention. I suppose that when Bill wrote this chapter, he could not have guessed the many struggles A.A. would have to go through to have the Third Tradition finally written and accepted so that we might continue to strive ever to be inclusive in our behaviors and our words, rather than exclusive.

Today A.A. has opened the doors in ways probably not imagined by the first members. At an almost dizzying speed: a recent conference Advisory Action to make the A.A. Preamble more inclusive and the request from the Fellowship to have a plain and simple language version of the Big Book to name a two of many efforts regarding overcoming barriers to access our A.A. message.

The Accessibilities and Remote Communities assignment has changed name several times in the last ten years to accommodate the growing list of barriers that exist between the A.A. message and the alcoholic out there. Accessibilities committees around the structure have helped make it possible that more and more members spring from their chairs to welcome the alcoholic entering a meeting room with the help of a cane or a wheelchair.

At our events many Areas do not think twice to spend the basket money to cover for interpretation, allowing large linguistic minorities to fully participate at Conventions, Assemblies and other A.A. events. The G.S.O. recently helped to facilitate an international effort to support Remote Communities from the North to connect with their counterparts in the South of the hemisphere we are in.

All of these efforts have uncovered large diverse communities that are today recovering with our program. They have read the basic principles and use the Service Manual. They help others in their communities. They are ready for more; they want to belong to A.A. as

a whole and they want to contribute. And it is in this regard that a lot of work is waiting to be done: We need to meet the “other” where they are at. It is hard to understand the needs of this population when you can’t engage with them, when we don’t engage with them.

At a recent accessibilities workshop, a member noted that perhaps AA is slowly rethinking the concept of people with barriers by turning the focus on the barriers we have to meet those alcoholics who are not in the room. Do we perhaps avoid sitting at a table with a minority that makes us feel uncomfortable? Or perhaps our expectations when we select trusted servants are not suitable for other cultures, social groups? Are we creating service material about certain cultures without including the members of those cultures?

As La Viña Magazine Editor, I attended many Regional Forums. Over the years, the format was improved to allow participation. Hispanic A.A. started to show up thanks to the interpretation services and to the translated materials available. There was excitement when we spoke in the hallways and at the workshops. In the morning, along with Board members and the Grapevine Editor, I gave the formal presentation about La Viña, in English. It seemed to me that right there we lost an opportunity to present vital information to the population that were the primary audience in their own language.

In terms of participation and inclusivity, some important steps have started to be taken. This year the General Service Board’s “Ad Hoc Committee on Encouraging Minority Participation Up the Triangle” recognized the Board’s role to promote inclusivity within the fellowship. The committee noted that demographically A.A. is not diverse, that minorities do not participate in the conversation at every level and that there is a need for more representation of the fellowship we serve.

You all know that the Hispanic community is the largest minority in the two countries of our service structure, the U.S and Canada. As I look around this room, I see that this population, in terms of percentage, is underrepresented. How do we get them here? Who else is not here?

We have powerful tools available to hear the voices of those who are not in the room and to possibly start to bring them to our table. An additional duty on the Accessibilities desk is to coordinate the Language Desk. Calls and emails that are in Spanish and French languages are routed to the Language Desk. Responding to inquiries in Spanish and French is a service with a long story at G.S.O. It would be impossible for me to handle these duties well if not for the experience that my fellow Staff members have been and continue to be so happy to share.

In March 2020 the world closed due to the Covid-19 pandemic. Suddenly, all the in-person meetings that were mostly inaccessible to many people with disabilities, made sure all abled bodied members could access the meetings from their homes. By doing so, these groups opened their virtual doors to many members with disabilities who were previously excluded from their in-person meetings and from A.A. as a whole.

This community hopes that online meetings will continue to provide a space for those confined to their house, to their beds, or physically isolated but now spiritually connected.

Many of them have shared that they may be able to participate in the General Service Structure.

During these challenging Covid times, many delegates have shared that the Hispanic participation at their Area Assemblies had decreased and, in some cases, disappeared completely. How could that happen with such active A.A. service members?

The reality is that even before Covid, few Linguistic Districts and Hispanic G.S.R.'s were connected to G.S.O. via email. The Hispanic population basically skipped entirely over the use of emails. Emails belong to the desktop computer users. The Hispanic population long ago used what was more affordable and available: smartphones.

Some years ago, the Grapevine Office opened a simple, inexpensive channel of communication with the Hispanic communities through text messaging. That small community kept connected through weekly quotes from AA Grapevine literature and monthly updates on La Viña. Hopefully we continue to ask those communities we serve how to best keep in touch.

Do we know how to communicate with minority populations? Do we know what they need to support their Twelve Step work?

Speaking of Grapevine and La Viña, aren't the magazines the voice of the fellowship? Are we using the "mirror of the fellowship" as Bill W. wrote, to help us to hear those alcoholics who are in the shadows, not yet at our table? How can we invite those A.A. members to participate? Wouldn't it be helpful to invite them to sit at the table and let them talk?

Years ago, on a trip to a Regional Forum I met a wonderful woman, Rosa, who was the local Hispanic District DCM. She was a big reason that many GSR's and La Viña service volunteers attended the Regional Forum that weekend. Her cook's shift had prevented her to attend. She was very upset but called me and I agreed to meet her at her workplace. She did not speak English and neither did the GSR's who were excited about the experience of attending the Forum.

"Ay mija!" Rosa said, "cuénteme de la Conferencia." After a few words, she told me how she encouraged her Hispanic District GSR's to overcome their fears and attend the Area Assembly by simply asking them to report on specific committees. Those first GSR's came back to the district and the groups with reports and empowered by the information gathered at the Assembly, they were now the experts. What a simple idea to keep the interest! It was clear to me that I was there for another PhD in A.A., one that I am forever grateful.

I look forward to the day, as I'm sure you all do as well, when one day instead of asking me about the Conference, Rosa, and many like her from minority populations, will be sharing at her Area how **her** experience was at the Conference.

Thank you so much for this invitation and I am looking forward to the sharing.